# Collective properties of injection□induced earthquake sequences: 1. Model description and directivity bias

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**Key Points:**
- Induced earthquake sequences modeled by crack propagation physics coupled with reservoir simulation
- Model shows bias for rupture directivity toward injection well where fluid pressure is high
- Directivity bias detected in hypothetical catalog by Kolmogorov-Smirnov comparison to tectonic norm

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# Collective properties of injection-induced earthquake sequences: 1. Model description and directivity bias

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**Abstract** Induced seismicity is of increasing concern for oil and gas, geothermal, and carbon sequestration operations, with several $M > 5$ events triggered in recent years. Modeling plays an important role in understanding the causes of this seismicity and in constraining seismic hazard. Here we study the collective properties of induced earthquake sequences and the physics underpinning them. In this first paper of a two-part series, we focus on the directivity ratio, which quantifies whether fault rupture is dominated by one (unilateral) or two (bilateral) propagating fronts. In a second paper, we focus on the spatiotemporal and magnitude-frequency distributions of induced seismicity. We develop a model that couples a fracture mechanics description of 1-D fault rupture with fractal stress heterogeneity and the evolving pore pressure distribution around an injection well that triggers earthquakes. The extent of fault rupture is calculated from the equations of motion for two tips of an expanding crack centered at the earthquake hypocenter. Under tectonic loading conditions, our model exhibits a preference for unilateral rupture and a normal distribution of hypocenter locations, two features that are consistent with seismological observations. On the other hand, catalogs of induced events when injection occurs directly onto a fault exhibit a bias toward ruptures that propagate toward the injection well. This bias is due to relatively favorable conditions for rupture that exist within the high-pressure plume. The strength of the directivity bias depends on a number of factors including the style of pressure buildup, the proximity of the fault to failure and event magnitude. For injection off a fault that triggers earthquakes, the modeled directivity bias is small and may be too weak for practical detection. For two hypothetical injection scenarios, we estimate the number of earthquake observations required to detect directivity bias.

## 1. Introduction

It is now well established that injection of fluids into the subsurface can destabilize critically stressed faults [*Healy et al.*, 1968; *Raleigh et al.*, 1976; *Zoback and Harjes*, 1997] causing earthquakes large enough to be felt at the surface. Increasingly, induced seismicity is occurring on basement faults in the US midcontinent [*Horton*, 2012; *Keranen et al.*, 2013; *Ellsworth*, 2013], likely because of massive saltwater disposal into deep aquifers overlying the basement [*Walsh and Zoback*, 2015; *Weingarten et al.*, 2015]. Induced seismicity also occurs in hydrothermal systems, where water extracted for electricity production is reinjected underground [*Batini et al.*, 1985; *Majer et al.*, 2007], and during high-pressure well stimulations aimed at creating an Enhanced Geothermal System (EGS) [*Majer et al.*, 2007; *Häring et al.*, 2008; *Dorbath et al.*, 2009].

In this study, we consider induced seismicity that is triggered by fluid pressure increase on the fault plane. However, human-caused earthquakes are also associated with reservoir impoundment and mining operations [*Gupta and Rastogi*, 1976]. They can also be triggered by stress changes outside a reservoir caused by volume, mass, or temperature changes within it, e.g., production induced seismicity [*Segall and Fitzgerald*, 1998].

An earthquake is induced on a fault when fluid pressure is raised enough that the Mohr-Coulomb failure criterion is satisfied; this occurs when shear stress equals the static strength, i.e., $\tau = \tau_s$. Initially, shear stress is below the static strength. However, raising pore pressure causes fault strength to drop [*Hubbert and Rubey*, 1959], and if this is large enough to satisfy the failure criterion, an earthquake is triggered. The initial static strength, $\tau_{s,0}$, and its value, $\tau_s$, modified due to an increase in pore pressure, $\Delta P$, are given by

$$\tau_{s,0} = f_s(\sigma_n - P_0), \qquad \tau_s = \tau_{s,0} - f_s \Delta P, \tag{1}$$

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where $\sigma_n$ is the normal stress, $P_0$ is the initial pore pressure, and $f_s$ is the static friction coefficient. For typical crustal rocks, $f_s$ ranges between 0.6 and 1.0 [*Byerlee*, 1978]. This pressurization mechanism was demonstrated by *Raleigh et al.* [1976] with a set of experiments at Rangely Oil Field, Colorado. Measurements were made of in situ stress and a critical pressure threshold for Mohr-Coulomb failure was determined; subsequently, earthquake activity in the field was modulated by raising and lowering the fluid pressure about this threshold.

Modeling plays an important role both in understanding the mechanisms of seismicity and in quantifying seismic hazard. For example, several studies have coupled deterministic simulation of evolving reservoir pressure with a description of the rupture process. In these studies, injection and pressure buildup trigger earthquakes by either a pressurization [e.g., *Cappa and Rutqvist*, 2011] or a poroelastic stressing mechanism [*Murphy et al.*, 2013]. Fault rupture is modeled by coupling a friction evolution law (linear slip weakening [*Cappa and Rutqvist*, 2011] and rate-and-state friction [e.g., *McClure and Horne*, 2011; *Dieterich et al.*, 2015]) with stress transfer processes on the fault (quasistatic [*Cappa and Rutqvist*, 2011], quasidynamic [e.g., *McClure and Horne*, 2011; *Dieterich et al.*, 2015], or fully dynamic [*Cappa and Rutqvist*, 2011]), sometimes with permeability enhancement [e.g., *McClure and Horne*, 2011]. In this study, we focus on modeling large catalogs of induced earthquakes on faults with spatially heterogeneous shear stress. The numerical method we use involves a semianalytical solution of a crack propagation equation with instantaneous slip-weakening friction and quasistatic stress transfer. The resulting model makes minor compromises with respect to physical complexity, which are compensated by substantial computational speedup that enables us to model large sequences. We compare model estimates of rupture size against the dynamic rupture simulator, MDSBI [*Dunham*, 2005] (Appendix C), which provides an estimate of the model error.

This paper is structured as follows: in section 2, we describe the main components of our model for tectonic and induced seismicity. This includes the theory governing rupture of 1-D antiplane cracks (2.2.2), fractal models of spatially correlated shear stress (2.3), triggering by tectonic loading or pressurization (2.4), and reservoir pressure evolution for several generic configurations of an injection-fault system (2.5). In section 3, we describe a catalog of earthquakes modeled under a tectonic loading condition and compare the collective directivity properties with seismological observations (3.2). Finally, in section 4, we compare catalogs of induced earthquakes modeled under a range of injection conditions to the tectonic reference catalog, provide an account for how backward directivity bias (rupture directed toward the injection well) is introduced when injection occurs directly onto a fault, and propose how such a bias might be detected in real earthquake catalogs (4.1). In a companion paper, we use our model to give a physical motivation for how spatiotemporal and magnitude-frequency properties differ for induced earthquakes with a particular application to a sequence of earthquakes that occurred near Guy and Greenbrier, Arkansas, in 2010–2011.

### 1.1. Directivity

Rupture on a fault of length, $L_0$, is conceptualized as a semi-infinite bilaterally expanding crack with crack tip propagation in the $x$ direction and crack normal in the $y$ direction (Figure 1). We define a hypocenter location, $x_h$, negative (or left-hand) and positive (or right-hand) crack lengths, $a_-$ and $a_+$, and total crack length $L = a_- + a_+$ (refer to Table 1 for a full list of symbols used in the text).

For our analysis of directivity, we classify two end-member types of fault rupture: bilateral and unilateral. For a strike-slip fault, a perfectly bilateral rupture is one that nucleates and sends two equal-velocity rupture fronts outward in opposite directions along the fault, both of which arrest at the same time and distance from the hypocenter. In contrast, a perfectly unilateral rupture has only a single propagating rupture front.

In practice, a rupture may begin as bilateral (two propagating fronts) but later become unilateral when one of the fronts arrests. In this paper, we use two measures to quantify the relative bilateral versus unilateral nature of a rupture: proportion unilateral rupture, $E$, and directivity ratio, $D$. Proportion unilateral rupture is introduced by *Boatwright* [2007] as

$$E = 1 - 2\alpha, \tag{2}$$

where we define the hypocentral location inside the ruptured area as $\alpha = a_-/L$ (distance from the left-hand edge of the rupture), which is different to the hypocentral location on the fault, $x_h$ (distance from the left-hand end of the fault).

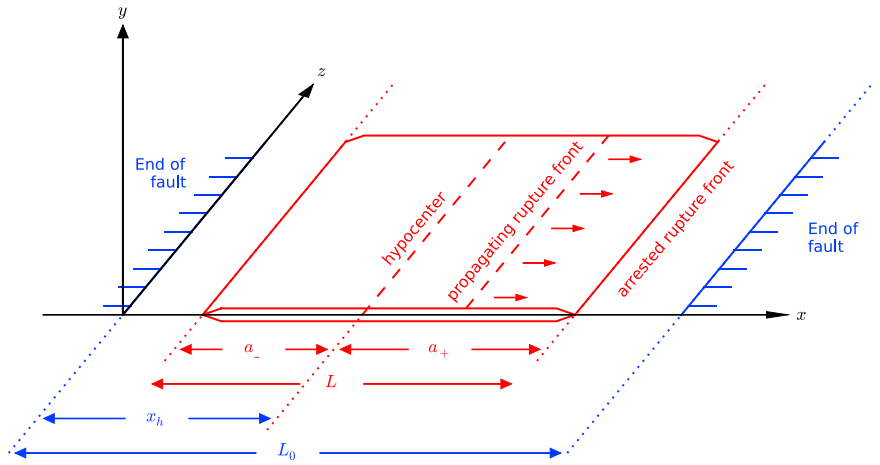



**Figure 1.** Schematic illustration of the semi-infinite expanding bilateral crack. A fault of length, $L_0$, hosts a rupture that nucleates at $x_h$ (the hypocenter) before propagating two crack tips in opposite directions along $x$, which eventually arrest with final rupture length, $L$. The distance between the negative and positive (or left-hand and right-hand) crack tips and $x_h$ is denoted $a_-$ and $a_+$.

The directivity ratio, $D$, is defined in terms of the second-order moments of the earthquake moment-release distribution [*McGuire et al.*, 2002]. For a simple 1-D rupture in which both fronts propagate at the same, constant velocity, the final slip distribution is constant, a slip rate is a delta function at the rupture front, and the directivity ratio is (Appendix A)

$$D = \frac{1 - 6\alpha^2 + 4\alpha^3}{\sqrt{1 - 12\alpha^2 + 24\alpha^3 - 12\alpha^4}}. \tag{3}$$

This expression is used to approximate $D$ for the ruptures considered in this study, in which slip rate is not likely to be a delta function (see Appendix C for further discussion of this approximation). Both $E$ and $D$ range between −1 and 1, with 0 indicating a perfectly bilateral rupture.

In the context of seismic hazard, directivity refers to the relative amplification of radiated seismic waves in the direction of propagation of fault rupture. We do not model these effects.

*McGuire et al.* [2002] report directivity ratios for 42 large shallow earthquakes and find that most ruptures are predominantly unilateral. They explain this result using a simple characteristic earthquake model and a uniform distribution for $\alpha$; preference for unilateral rupture is then a consequence of (3).

The two directivity measures are often expressed in terms of strength and along-fault direction; respectively, these correspond to the magnitude and sign of $D$ or $E$. In some situations, a signed measure of directivity is useful, e.g., when comparing ruptures that travel in different directions along a fault. When referring to a single rupture, it is more common to drop the sign and just quote the direction of travel; e.g., *Wald and Heaton* [1994] describe the 1992 Landers earthquake in which unilateral rupture propagated in the NW direction along a series of faults.

In our modeling study, there are no map directions against which to define the sign of rupture directivity. However, we find it useful to retain the sign of $D$ and $E$ so that rupture direction can be compared against other ruptures. We also define the sign of $D$ and $E$, so it has precise meaning with respect to the position of the injection well: negative and positive signs for ruptures traveling, respectively, toward and away from the well. Note, this implies that $\alpha$ must also be defined with respect to the position of the injection well, i.e., $\alpha = 0$ indicates the hypocenter is on the side of the rupture nearest the injection well.

## 2. Model Description

Our model estimates two properties of earthquakes on faults with arbitrary shear stress heterogeneity: (i) the location of the earthquake hypocenter and (ii) the final length of the ruptured section of the fault. We determine hypocenter location by a Mohr-Coulomb criterion that takes the pore pressure evolution on the fault into account. To estimate rupture extent, we consider a bilaterally expanding crack and solve the equations of motion for the two crack tips to identify where each arrests, yielding a final rupture length.

**Table 1.** Table of Symbols and Acronyms[a]

| Symbol | Meaning |
|---|---|
| $a_{\pm}$, $a_c$ | Crack tip position, critical crack length |
| $A$, $B$ | RS direct effect, state evolution parameter |
| $c_1$, $c_2$ | Fitting parameters |
| $c_s$ | Shear wave velocity |
| $C_r$ | Pressurization/criticality ratio |
| $C_w$ | Well conductance term |
| $D$ | Directivity ratio |
| $D_c$ | Critical slip distance |
| $E$ | Proportion unilateral rupture |
| $f$, $f_0$, $f_s$, $f_r$, $f_p$ | Friction coefficient, RS reference, static, residual, peak |
| $G$ | Energy release rate |
| $k$ | Spatial wavenumber |
| $K_{\pm}$ | Stress intensity factor |
| $L$, $L_0$, | Rupture, fault length |
| $n$ | Fractal exponent |
| $M_W$ | Earthquake magnitude |
| $P_D$, $P_\tau$, $P_\alpha$ | PDF for directivity ratio, stress, hypocenter location |
| $P_0$ | Pore pressure |
| $x_h$ | Hypocentral location on fault |
| $\Delta P$, $\Delta P_{\text{inj}}$ | Overpressure, value applied at injector |
| $\Delta P_{\text{max}}$ | Overpressure causing tensile failure |
| $V_0$, $V_{\text{min}}$, $V_{\text{max}}$ | Reference slip velocity, initial, maximum coseismic |
| $v_{\pm}$ | Crack tip propagation velocity |
| $\alpha$ | Hypocentral location inside rupture (normalized) |
| $\Gamma$ | Fracture energy |
| $\kappa$ | Permeability |
| $\mu$ | Shear modulus |
| $\mu_\tau$ | Mean of stress PDF |
| $\theta$, $\theta_{ss}$ | RS state variable, steady state value |
| $\phi$ | Porosity |
| $\sigma_n$ | Normal stress |
| $\sigma_\tau$, $\sigma_\alpha$ | Standard deviation of $P_\tau$ and $P_\alpha$ |
| $\tau$, $\bar{\tau}$ | Shear stress, average on fault |
| $\tau_s$, $\tau_r$, $\tau_p$ | Static strength, residual, and peak |
| $\rho$ | Fluid density |
| $\eta$ | Fluid viscosity |
| Acronym | |
| 2DF | 2-D fault catalog |
| EGS | Enhanced Geothermal System |
| H1 | Advancing front catalog |
| KS | Kolmogorov-Smirnov |
| MDSBI | Multidimensional Spectral Boundary Integral rupture code |
| PDF | Probability density function |
| RS | Rate and state |
| TR0 | Tectonic Reference catalog |

[a]Starred symbols (*) refer to dimensionless quantities. Stress variables with the subscript 0 refer to initial quantities when $\Delta P = 0$.

### 2.1. Stress and Strength Definitions

It is useful to start by defining terminology and nondimensional variables that appear ubiquitously in this paper. A fault is commonly conceptualized as a 2-D planar discontinuity embedded in the 3-D crust. Resolved upon the fault is a traction vector that, for an arbitrary basis aligned with the fracture plane, has one component normal to the fault plane, the normal stress, $\sigma_n$, and two in-plane shear stresses. In our model, we consider a cross section through the fault plane in the direction of rupture propagation, which reduces the fault to a 1-D discontinuity embedded in a 2-D domain. In this case, there is only a single shear stress component, $\tau$.

Failure on a fault is assumed to be governed by the Mohr-Coulomb criterion with initial and pressure-modified values of the static strength given by equation (1). During an earthquake, frictional weakening on the interface causes strength to decrease to a residual value, $\tau_{r,0}$, with associated friction coefficient, $f_r$. Similar to (1), residual strength is modified by an increase in fluid pressure so that we write

$$\tau_{r,0} = f_r(\sigma_n - P_0), \qquad \tau_r = \tau_{r,0} - f_r \Delta P. \tag{4}$$

We assume that $\tau$ drops to $\tau_r$ during rupture, i.e., stress equals residual strength, and in doing so neglect here the physics of overshoot or undershoot [*Kanamori and Rivera*, 2006].

#### 2.1.1. Nondimensional Parameters

While our model is dimensional, it is useful to define nondimensional parameters for general discussion of model results. We use $\tau_{s,0}$ and $\tau_{r,0}$ to define the nondimensional pressure change, following the convention that all nondimensional quantities are starred (*)

$$\Delta P^* = \frac{f_r \Delta P}{\tau_{s,0} - \tau_{r,0}}. \tag{5}$$

Nondimensional residual and static strengths are defined relative to $\tau_{r,0}$

$$\tau_r^* = \frac{\tau_r - \tau_{r,0}}{\tau_{s,0} - \tau_{r,0}} = -\Delta P^*, \tag{6}$$

$$\tau_s^* = \frac{\tau_s - \tau_{r,0}}{\tau_{s,0} - \tau_{r,0}} = 1 - \frac{f_s}{f_r}\Delta P^*, \tag{7}$$

from which it follows that $\tau_{r,0}^* = 0$ and $\tau_{s,0}^* = 1$. All stresses with the subscript 0 imply $\Delta P^* = 0$.

In contrast to (6) and (7), nondimensional shear stress is defined relative to the residual strength, $\tau_r$, which could be modified by changes in pressure

$$\tau^* = \frac{\tau - \tau_r}{\tau_{s,0} - \tau_{r,0}} = \tau_0^* + \Delta P^*. \tag{8}$$

The Mohr-Coulomb criterion (1) is then written

$$\tau_0^* = 1 - \frac{f_s}{f_r}\Delta P^*, \tag{9}$$

which accounts for the two mechanisms of triggering: an increase in tectonic stress (increasing $\tau_0^*$) or overpressure leading to static strength reduction (increasing $\Delta P^*$).

We refer to the quantity $\tau^*$ as the potential stress drop. It incorporates both the shear stress on the fault, $\tau_0^*$, as well as the lowering of residual strength at elevated fluid pressure, $\Delta P^*$, into a single quantity that represents the possible reduction in shear stress that can occur during rupture. The value of potential stress drop averaged over the entire fault is denoted $\bar{\tau}^*$, which is similar to the definition of *Ripperger et al.* [2007] except that our $\tau_r$ has pressure dependence and thus changes during injection. The actual stress drop, $\Delta\bar{\tau}^*$, is the integral of $\tau^*$ over the ruptured portion of the fault, weighted by an assumed elliptical slip distribution [*Madariaga*, 1979]

$$\Delta\bar{\tau}^* = \int_1^{-1} \tau^* \sqrt{1 - (z^*)^2}\, dz^*, \tag{10}$$

where $z^*$ spans the rupture.

One additional constraint is that stress conditions on the fault remain in a shear failure regime, which requires that $\Delta P^* < \Delta P^*_{\max} = f_r/(f_s - f_r)$ (equivalent to $\Delta P < (\sigma_n - P_0)$).

We use the fault length, $L_0$, to nondimensionalize all spatial units; e.g., $x^* = x/L_0$. Nondimensional time, $t^*$, is defined in terms of the timescale for pressure diffusion through the fault of permeability, $\kappa_f$

$$t^* = \frac{\rho g \kappa_f}{\eta L_0} t, \tag{11}$$

where $\rho$ is fluid density ($\sim 10^3$ kg m$^{-3}$), $g$ is the acceleration of gravity, and $\eta$ is the viscosity of water ($\sim 8.9 \times 10^{-4}$ Pa s).

### 2.2. One-Dimensional Fracture Model

#### 2.2.1. Modeling Approach, Approximations, and Limitations

The goal of this study is to use a model for 1-D fracture mechanics to provide insight into earthquakes on 2-D faults. This approach is attractive as there exist a number of exact integral solutions for 1-D fracture propagation [e.g., *Eshelby*, 1969; *Rice*, 1980], and thus, the computational expense of dynamic 2-D rupture simulations is avoided. Nevertheless, there are limitations associated with the reduction of dimensionality and these are discussed below.

The principal limitation is the exclusion of 2-D effects, primarily the ability of rupture on a 2-D fault to skirt around a barrier that might otherwise impede propagation on a 1-D fault. The 1-D models used here also make several simplifying assumptions about friction evolution such that dynamic overshoot and aseismic slip are unaccounted. However, in spite of these limitations, 1-D fracture models replicate several features of earthquakes observed in nature or in the laboratory including a distribution of magnitudes [*Ampuero et al.*, 2006], the relationship between the size of frictional slip precursors and the level of shear stress [*Kammer et al.*, 2015], and critical fracture lengths required for a transition from aseismic slip to runaway sliding [*Ampuero and Ben-Zion*, 2008; *Galis et al.*, 2015]. In addition, some features of the 1-D crack model appear to scale to more complex simulations of 2-D rupture, such as a critical level of available stress drop above which there is transition from Gutenberg-Richter to Characteristic Earthquake statistics [*Ampuero et al.*, 2006; *Ripperger et al.*, 2007].

Thus, we adopt a conservative approach to interpreting insights gained from a 1-D model and their implications for the behavior of 2-D fault ruptures: a qualitative agreement is expected depending on specific consideration of the neglected 2-D rupture effects. Quantitative agreement is less likely, and, as such, caution is exercised in quantitative comparisons between model results and observations.

#### 2.2.2. Crack Tip Equation of Motion

Arrest of a rupture front propagating along a fault is modeled using fracture mechanics arguments. We consider bilateral propagation of a finite, mode III crack embedded in an infinite homogeneous, isotropic elastic medium (Figure 1). The fracture is contained in the $x^*$-$z^*$ plane with the normal direction parallel to the $y^*$ axis and the two crack tips propagating in the negative and positive $x^*$ directions. In a purely elastic framework, shear slip on the crack results in a stress singularity at the crack tip. One way to address the nonphysical singularity is to consider, as the tip advances, the energy that enters and is consumed within an infinitesimal region enclosing the tip. This defines the nondimensional energy release rate, $G^*$, which is energy release per unit area advance of the crack tip. *Eshelby* [1969] expresses the energy release rate at one tip of a finite, mode III crack, expanding along the $x^*$ axis with initial position at $x^* = 0$

$$G^* = \frac{1}{2\mu^*} \left( \frac{1 - v^*}{1 + v^*} \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} (K^*)^2 , \tag{12}$$

where $v^* (= v/c_s)$ is the nondimensional velocity at which the crack tip is propagating, $c_s$ is the shear wave speed in the medium, $\mu^* = \mu/(\tau_{s,0} - \tau_{r,0})$ is the nondimensional shear modulus, and the nondimensional stress intensity factor, $K^*$, is given by

$$K^* = \sqrt{\frac{2}{\pi}} \int_0^{a^*} \frac{\tau^*}{\sqrt{a^* - x^*}} \mathrm{d}x^*, \tag{13}$$

where $a^*$ is the position along the $x^*$ axis of the crack tip and $\tau^*$ is the potential stress drop behind the advancing crack tip. Note, this form of $K^*$ assumes $\tau^*$=0 for $x < 0$.

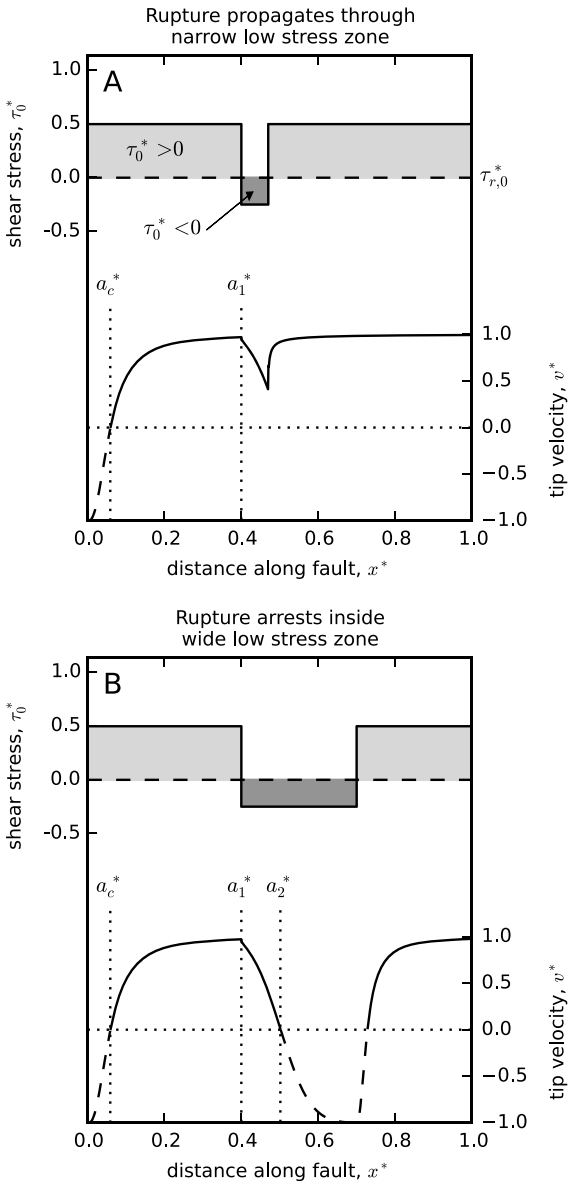



**Figure 2.** (a) Evolution of the crack tip velocity, $v^*$, on a fault where $\tau_0^* > 0$ (energy source) except for a narrow region of $\tau_0^* < 0$ (energy sink) beginning at crack tip position $a_1^*$. (b) Same as for Figure 2a but for a wider region of $\tau_0^* < 0$. In this case, the rupture arrests at crack tip position $a_2^*$. Note, the critical crack length, $a_c^*$, indicates where rupture velocity first becomes positive. In this simple example, we assume there is no pressure change, i.e., $\tau^* = \tau_0^*$.

This approximation of fault rupture necessarily imposes a number of simplifications on what is acknowledged to be a complex physical problem. For example, it assumes a planar interface whereas real faults are known to be geometrically complex [e.g., *Power et al.*, 1988; *Candela et al.*, 2009]. It neglects the interacting stress waves that diffract back and forth between the two tips of a propagating rupture (discussed further below). It neglects the effects of a free surface and therefore will be less accurate for events that rupture to the surface. It assumes homogeneity of the rock matrix and therefore cannot capture bimaterial effects [e.g., *Ben-Zion*, 2001] or other consequences of inhomogeneity. Nevertheless, this relatively simple model captures much of the fundamental physics of crack propagation and is therefore a useful (and fast) tool for exploring first-order earthquake behavior.

For two surfaces in frictional contact, we assume that energy consumed within the crack tip region is used to weaken the strength of the contact surface from the peak value that shear stress reaches during rupture, $\tau_p^*$, to the residual value, $\tau_r^*$. Such frictional weakening is not instantaneous but rather occurs over the slip-weakening distance, $D_c^*$. The work required to achieve frictional weakening from $\tau_p^*$ to $\tau_r^*$ defines the fracture energy, $\Gamma^*$. Setting the expression for energy release rate (12) equal to the fracture energy, i.e., $G^* = \Gamma^*$, yields an equation of motion for the position of the crack tip

$$v^* = \frac{1 - \left(2\Gamma^*\mu^*/(K^*)^2\right)^2}{1 + \left(2\Gamma^*\mu^*/(K^*)^2\right)^2}. \tag{14}$$

For constant $\tau^*$, the expression for the stress intensity factor (13) reduces to $\tau^*\sqrt{8a^*/\pi}$. Inserting this in (14) and requiring the numerator to be positive yields an expression for the critical crack length for rupture propagation

$$a_c^* = \frac{\pi\mu^*\Gamma^*}{2(\tau^*)^2}. \tag{15}$$

Assuming that initially $a^* > a_c^*$, then if $\tau^*$ remains positive (shear stress exceeds residual strength) and large enough the crack tip velocity will accelerate and approach the shear wave velocity, $c_s$ (or $v^*$ approaches one, see Figure 2). If the crack tip enters a region of $\tau^* < 0$ (shear stress is less than residual strength), the energy release rate decreases and the crack tip velocity will decrease. Depending on the size of such regions, the

crack tip velocity may drop to zero, indicating arrest of the propagating rupture. Finding the locations where $v^* = 0$ is central in determining the length of fault rupture and thus its directivity ratio.

In the models considered here, shear stress is assumed to be heterogeneous and spatially correlated, i.e., $\tau_0^*(x^*)$. Furthermore, the definition of $\tau^*$ includes the dimensionless pressure change, $\Delta P^*$, which is also not likely to be constant in space, e.g., the highest pore pressures are often located near to injection wells. For arbitrary spatial variation of fault shear stress, $K^*$ in (13) is computed by convolution of $\tau^*(x^*)$ with $1/\sqrt{x^*}$.

For a finite crack, where two crack tips propagate away from one another in the $+x^*$ and $-x^*$ directions, approximate versions of the equations of motion are

$$v_\pm^* = \frac{1 - \left(2\Gamma^* \mu^* / (K_\pm^*)^2\right)^2}{1 + \left(2\Gamma^* \mu^* / (K_\pm^*)^2\right)^2}, \qquad K_\pm^* = \sqrt{\frac{2}{\pi}} \int_{a_\pm^*}^{a_\pm^*} \frac{\tau^*}{\sqrt{|a_\pm^* - x^*|}} \mathrm{d}x^*, \tag{16}$$

where $a_+$ and $a_-$ are respectively the positions of the crack tip in the $+x^*$ and $-x^*$ directions. Equation (16) is an extension of (13) and (14) that explicitly neglects interaction between the two crack tips, such as occurs when stress waves diffract back and forth along the crack [e.g., *Ing and Ma*, 1997]. The stress intensity factor $K^*$ for a crack of finite size and heterogeneous stress drop, and incorporating such interactions is given by *Rice* [1980], equation (5.21). These two expressions for $K^*$ (16) bound the effects of tip interactions. We use the approximation (16) because this form is efficient to solve by convolution. The adequacy of this and other model approximations is evaluated by comparison against dynamic rupture simulations (Appendix C).

### 2.3. Stress Heterogeneity

We conceptualize shear stress heterogeneity on a fault as the cumulative effect of many earthquakes, each contributing a spatially complex stress drop. This, in turn, is associated with complex slip patterns and geometric roughness. A number of studies have treated fault roughness, patterns of coseismic slip and stress drop as spatially correlated fields conforming to an underlying fractal model [*Power et al.*, 1988; *Candela et al.*, 2009; *Andrews*, 1980; *Herrero and Bernard*, 1994; *Mai and Beroza*, 2002; *Ampuero et al.*, 2006]. For a spatially varying field, $\psi$, the fractal spatial correlation model is defined by power law dependence of the amplitude spectrum, i.e.,

$$|\tilde{\psi}(k)| \propto k^{-n}, \tag{17}$$

where $\tilde{\psi}$ is the Fourier transform of $\psi$, $k$ is the spatial wave number, and $n$ is the fractal exponent. For example, fault roughness is characterized by $n = 2.5–3.0$ [*Power et al.*, 1988; *Candela et al.*, 2009] and coseismic slip distributions by $n = 1.7–2.0$ [*Andrews*, 1980; *Herrero and Bernard*, 1994; *Mai and Beroza*, 2002].

We assume that shear stress on a fault, $\tau_0^*$, is consistent with a fractal model with exponent $n = 0.25$. A full analysis of this parameter, including an appropriate range of values obtained from observational studies as well as its implications for the magnitude-frequency distribution of modeled catalogs, is included in the second paper. Figure 3a shows an example of $k^{-0.25}$ shear stress heterogeneity. Spatially correlated profiles are generated by multiplying the wave number vector $k^{-0.25}$ by random phase angles and then taking the inverse Fourier transform. This generates zero-mean spatially correlated noise with values approximately drawn from a Gaussian probability density function (PDF, Figure 3b).

The issue of an appropriate PDF for values of $\tau_0^*$ has received some attention recently. Generally, normal distributions are used in dynamic rupture modeling studies [e.g., *Ripperger et al.*, 2007; *Aagaard and Heaton*, 2008; *Dieterich et al.*, 2015]. *Helmstetter and Shaw* [2006] suggests that postrupture shear stress changes should follow an exponential distribution, which results in Omori-type decay of aftershocks in a simplified rate-and-state friction model. In this study, we use a positively skewed Gumbel distribution for the stress PDF:

$$P_\tau = \exp\left[-\frac{\tau_0^* - \mu_\tau^*}{\sigma_\tau^*}\right] \exp\left[-\exp\left(-\frac{\tau_0^* - \mu_\tau^*}{\sigma_\tau^*}\right)\right], \tag{18}$$

where $\mu_\tau^*$ and $\sigma_\tau^*$ are the distribution mean and standard deviation. For large $\tau_0^*$, the argument of the second exponential factor in (18) approaches zero; thus, the right-hand tail of (18) approximates an exponential, consistent with the result of *Helmstetter and Shaw* [2006]. Figure 3 compares two profiles sharing the same spatial correlation before and after rescaling to a Gumbel PDF. The primary effect is to accentuate peaks in shear stress where an earthquake is likely to be triggered.

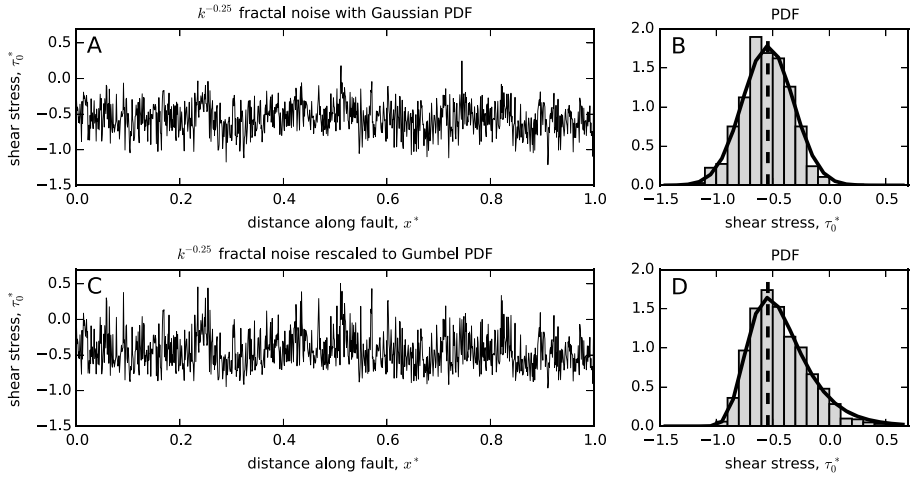



**Figure 3.** Examples of 1-D heterogeneous fault shear stress profiles. A. $k^{-0.25}$ spatially correlated shear stress generated by applying random phase angles to a $k^{-0.25}$ profile in the wavenumber domain. This filtering procedure outputs a stress profile with values whose PDF approximately conforms to a Gaussian distribution (B) with mean, $\mu_\tau^*$=-0.54 (vertical dashed line), and standard deviation, $\sigma_\tau^*$=0.225. C. The same stress profile but with the PDF rescaled to a Gumbel distribution (D, see also equation (18)) with the same mean and standard deviation.

### 2.4. Rupture Triggering and Hypocenter Determination

An instability grows into a propagating rupture when shear stress over a sufficiently large region of a fault—the critical crack length, $a_c^*$—is above the static strength, $\tau_s^*$. The hypocenter location must be determined before the crack tip equation of motion (16) can be used to estimate rupture length.

Tectonic earthquakes are triggered as a result of far-field plate motion that transfers elastic strain onto a fault, incrementally increasing shear stress at the frictional interface. In our model, we assume this process operates uniformly across the fault. For a given heterogeneous shear stress profile (e.g., Figure 3c), rupture nucleates at the location of highest shear stress on the fault—the earthquake hypocenter, $x_h^*$—after stress increase, $\Delta\tau_{\text{fail}}^* = \tau_s^* - \max(\tau_0^*(x^*))$. Potential stress drop on the fault when the rupture length is computed is $\tau^* = \tau_0^* + \Delta\tau_{\text{fail}}^*$.

In contrast, the triggering mechanism for an induced earthquake is a reduction of $\tau_s^*$ in locations of elevated pore pressure. Pressure evolution, and thus strength reduction, has spatial and temporal components; i.e, $\Delta P^*(x^*, t^*)$ implies $\tau_s^*(x^*, t^*)$. Therefore, we look for the first instance in time, $t_h^*$, when the Mohr-Coulomb criterion (9) is satisfied (this is the event time) and take the location where it is satisfied as the hypocenter, $x_h^*$.

One important distinction is that whereas we have assumed for tectonic loading the stress increase is uniform across the fault, for pressurization, strength reduction is not uniform. Instead, it occurs only where there is a local elevation of the pore pressure. Therefore, constraining the shape, magnitude, and time evolution of the pressure plume becomes an important consideration in our analysis of induced seismicity.

### 2.5. Pressure Plume Evolution

Evolution of pore pressure on a fault depends on the geometric and hydrologic properties of the combined aquifer-fault system as well as operational parameters such as injection rate or wellhead pressure. We perform reservoir simulations of fault pressure evolution based on Darcy flow for two idealized injection geometries that might arise in real-world cases of induced seismicity (Figure 4). We also consider one scenario in which pressure evolution is a prescribed function. The three scenarios are the following:

1. Two-dimensional or radial flow, describing injection directly into a planar fault and fluid flow along both in-plane directions. This also describes pressure buildup in a horizontally extensive aquifer due to a fully penetrating injection well.
2. Extended two-dimensional flow, as might arise during injection into a horizontally extensive aquifer overlying impermeable crystalline basement that contains a vertically oriented, permeable fault. Pressure evolution both in the aquifer and the fault is 2-D but in planes perpendicular to each other. This geometry

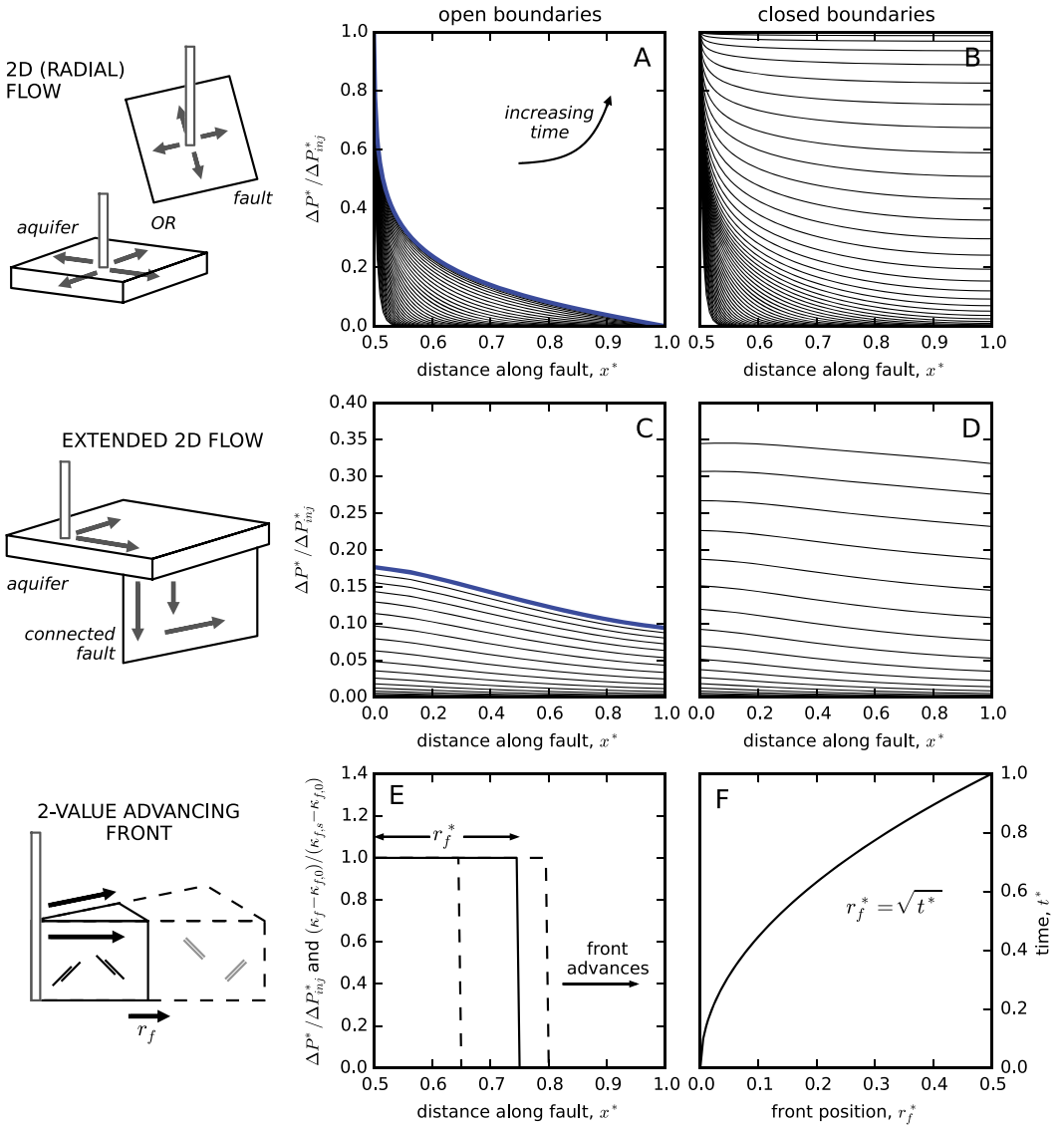



**Figure 4.** Summary of pressure evolution scenarios for (a and b) 2-D radial flow, (c and d) extended 2-D flow in an aquifer with a connected basement fault, and (e and f) a two-value advancing pressure front. Plots show pressure rise along the fault in each flow scenario at different times for $\kappa_f$=$10^{-14}$ m$^2$. The arrow in Figure 4a indicates the general change in profiles with increasing time. In Figure 4e, both $\Delta P^*$ and the inferred permeability change are described by a Heaviside step function whose position, $r_f^*$, advances at a rate proportional to $\sqrt{t^*}$. For the 2-D flow and advancing front scenarios, $\Delta P^*$ is symmetrical about $x^* = 0.5$.

is appropriate for basement seismicity triggered by saltwater disposal in the central U.S. [e.g., *Horton*, 2012; *Zhang et al.*, 2013].

3. Advancing two-value step function. This assumes rapid pressure buildup inside a near-well region of permeability enhancement and a sharp pressure drop at a defined front. Studies suggest that [*McClure and Horne*, 2011; *Gischig and Wiemer*, 2013] this is a reasonable description of pressure evolution when permeability enhancement dominates.

For the 2-D and extended 2-D geometries, spatiotemporal evolution of pressure buildup is mainly controlled by fault permeability, $\kappa_f$, injection pressure, $\Delta P_{\text{inj}}$, and, for the extended 2-D geometry, the location of the well relative to the fault. For single-phase, isothermal flow, pressure evolution is computed by solving for mass conservation assuming a Darcy-flow law

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t}(\rho\phi) + \nabla \cdot \boldsymbol{q} + Q = 0, \qquad \boldsymbol{q} = -\frac{\kappa\rho}{\eta}\left(\nabla P - \rho g\hat{\boldsymbol{z}}\right), \tag{19}$$

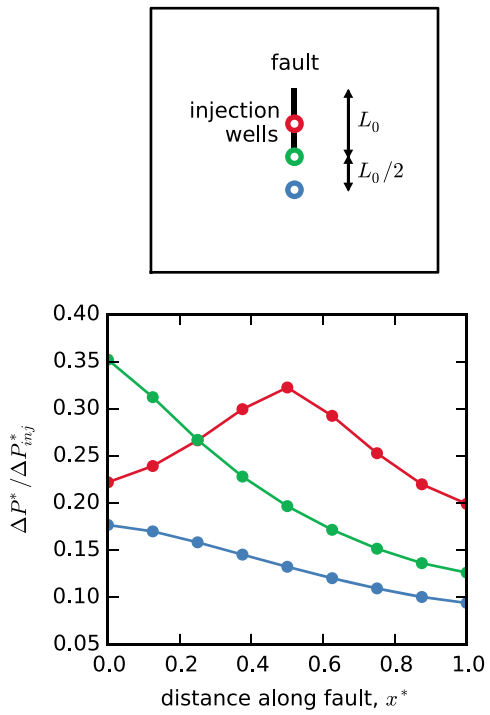



**Figure 5.** Well and fault geometry for extended 2-D reservoir simulation. (a) Three locations of injection wells relative to connected basement fault. (b) Pressure buildup on the basement fault for the three locations.

where $\boldsymbol{q}$ is mass flux, $P$ is pore pressure, $\rho$ and $\eta$ are the density and viscosity of water and have prescribed polynomial dependence on $P$, $\kappa$ and $\phi$ are permeability and porosity of rock and can be spatially variable but are assumed to be constant in time, $g$ is gravity, and $Q$ is a mass source term for injection at fixed pressure

$$Q = C_w(\Delta P_{\text{inj}} - (P_w - P_{w,0})), \tag{20}$$

where $P_w$ is the pore pressure at the location of the well, $P_{w,0}$ is its initial value, and $C_w$ is a well conductance term. The injection pressure, $\Delta P_{\text{inj}}$, is the overpressure at the bottom of the well and will be higher than the wellhead pressure if the formation is initially underpressured. In this work, we use the implementation of Equations (19) and (20) in the flow simulator FEHM [*Zyvoloski*, 2007].

We perform simulations of injection and pressure evolution for the two flow geometries for representative ranges of $\Delta P_{\text{inj}}$ (1 to 20 MPa) and $\kappa_f$ ($10^{-12}$ to $10^{-16}$ m$^2$). We have tested both open (constant pressure) and closed (zero flow) boundary conditions and will present results for both when there is an effect on simulation outcomes. For the 2-D geometry, the computational domain has the same dimensions as the fault, $L_0$, and is meshed with a rectangular grid with refining resolution toward an injection well situated at the center of the fault, $x^* = 0.5$. In the first part of this two-part series, we model injection against a fixed pressure. In reality, injection occurs at a fixed or unsteady flow rate, sometimes with restrictions on the operating wellhead pressure. Variable rate injection is considered in the companion paper, specifically addressing a sequence of earthquakes that occurred in Arkansas in 2010–2011 [*Horton*, 2012].

For the extended 2-D geometry, the position of the injection well relative to the fault must be specified. We construct a computational domain that is large enough for boundary effects on the fault and injection well to be negligible. Aquifer permeability is set to $10^{-14}$ m$^2$ and porosity to 10%, which is of a typical range for disposal formations and ensures enough pressure buildup on the fault for earthquakes to be triggered. We consider three different locations of the injection well, all aligned with the strike of the fault: (i) off fault, (ii) end of fault, and (iii) midfault (Figure 5a). We have also investigated a range of locations that are offset from the strike of the fault and found that they produce seismicity very similar to the off-fault position. Note that while the reservoir simulation captures how fluid flows downward into the fault from the aquifer, in the earthquake simulations presented here, we consider only lateral variations in pressure along the fault.

The 2-D and extended 2-D scenarios assume that fault permeability is unaffected by earthquake activity. However, injection for the purpose of creating an Enhanced Geothermal System is explicitly designed to achieve permeability stimulation through self-propping shear failure [*Majer et al.*, 2007]. Induced seismicity associated with other operations may also trigger permeability enhancement. The final scenario therefore is a simple model of pressure evolution that assumes a stimulated region, symmetric about the injection well, in which permeability, $\kappa_f^s$, is much higher than on the rest of the fault, $\kappa_f^0$. We assume that growth of the zone has a square root time dependence, i.e., $r_f^*(t) = \sqrt{t^*}$, where $r_f^*$ is the radial distance between the stimulation front and the injection well and, in this case, dimensionless time is given, $t^* = tD/L_0^*$, with a diffusivity, $D$. This form for propagation of the damage front is motivated by analytical solutions from *McClure and Horne* [2010] and *Lewis et al.* [2013] derived from the diffusivity equation for a range of problem geometries and under conditions of permeability enhancement.

We further assume that pressure has sufficient time to equilibrate with the evolving permeability distribution. In the limiting case where $\kappa_f^s/\kappa_f^0 \to \infty$, pressure is constant from the injection well to $r_f^*(t^*)$ and then declines

rapidly for $r^* > r_f^*(t^*)$. We approximate this pressure evolution by a radial step function

$$\Delta P^*(r^*, t^*) = \Delta P^*_{\text{inj}} H(r^* - r_f^*(t^*)), \tag{21}$$

where $H(r^*)$ is the Heaviside step function. As for the 2-D flow scenario, injection occurs at the center of the fault ($x^* = 0.5$) about which $\Delta P^*$ is symmetrical. While more complex models for pressure and permeability evolution have been investigated [e.g., *McClure and Horne*, 2011; *Miller*, 2015; *Dempsey et al.*, 2015], the purpose here is to capture the essential features of such pressure evolution and to assess their impact on the seismicity observables of interest. For instance, in practical situations, one would expect some finite pressure drop across the stimulated region, and pressure within the region may either increase [*McClure and Horne*, 2010; *Lewis et al.*, 2013] or decrease over time [*Dempsey et al.*, 2015] depending on the mechanisms of stimulation.

We show snapshots of simulated fault pressure buildup, $\Delta P^*(x^*, t^*)$, for the three scenarios in Figure 4. For the 2-D flow geometry, at early time, overpressure is peaked sharply at $x^* = 0.5$ where injection occurs (Figures 4a and 4b). However, continued pressure rise along the rest of the fault means that the portion of the fault at or above a given overpressure increases with time. For extended 2-D flow, the pressure perturbation is less pronounced (Figures 4c and 4d). While the near-well region still experiences the highest pressure and sharpest pressure gradients, this region is located away from the fault (in the aquifer). The shape of the pressure plume depends on the location of the injection well (Figure 5). The off-fault and end-of-fault wells generate a plume with monotonic pressure decrease along the fault, while the midfault well exhibits pressure decline either side of a peak at the center of the fault.

### 2.6. Earthquake Catalog Simulation

Having introduced the main components of our model, we now describe our procedure for simulating tectonic and induced earthquakes on 1-D faults and for building up a catalog of modeled earthquakes. There are three steps involved in modeling a single earthquake (Figure 6):

1. Construction of a heterogeneous shear stress profile, $\tau_0^*(x^*)$, assumed to be spatially correlated according to a fractal model and with a PDF of values drawn from a Gumbel distribution (equation (18)). The required parameters for this step are the fractal exponent, $n$, and the mean, $\mu_\tau^*$, and standard deviation, $\sigma_\tau^*$, of the stress PDF.
2. Determination of hypocenter location, $x_h^*$. For a tectonic event, $x_h^*$ is the location of highest shear stress on the fault. For an induced event, profiles of evolving $\Delta P^*$ are tested for satisfaction of the Mohr-Coulomb criterion, with $x_h^*$ being the location where $\tau_0^*(x_h^*) = 1 - \Delta P^*(x_h^*) f_s / f_r$. The required parameters for this step are geometry of the fault injection well system, injection pressure, $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$, fault permeability, $\kappa_f$, and the location of the injection well (for extended 2-D geometry). Static and residual friction coefficients, $f_s$ and $f_r$, are also required.
3. Calculation of rupture extent, $L^*$. We model fault rupture as two crack tips propagating in opposite directions along the fault, both beginning at $x_h^*$. The location where each crack tip arrests depends on the balance of energy source ($\tau^* > 0$) and sink ($\tau^* < 0$) regions on the fault. We compute crack arrest by solving the crack tip equation of motion (16) (see Appendix B for algorithm details). The required parameters for this step are $f_s$, $f_r$, and the fracture energy, $\Gamma^*$.

One way to model an earthquake catalog is as an ensemble of fault ruptures, each simulated (following steps 1–3 above) on a fault with a different realization of $\tau_0^*$ constructed from the same stress model (the same approach was taken by *Ampuero et al.* [2006] and *Ripperger et al.* [2007]). Constructing a catalog in this way averages out features and behavior attributable to any specific realization of shear stress heterogeneity while still incorporating heterogeneity in both triggering and rupture computations (steps 2 and 3 above). This is important for our probabilistic analysis of directivity ratio (this paper) and magnitude-frequency distributions (companion paper).

#### 2.6.1. Evolving Fault Stress

It is expected that stress on a fault is modified by prior earthquakes. The ability of our model to approximate long periods or large amounts of seismicity thus depends on how we describe the evolving stress state. We continue with a stochastic approach and propose that at time, $t^*$, average stress on the fault has been modified from its initial value and now reflects the distribution of pressure buildup, $\Delta P^*(x^*, t^*)$. Specifically, average stress is lower in regions of higher pressure increase (implicitly, more earthquakes have been triggered here and thus more stress released) and is nearer to its initial value in regions of minimal pressure rise (Figure 7b).

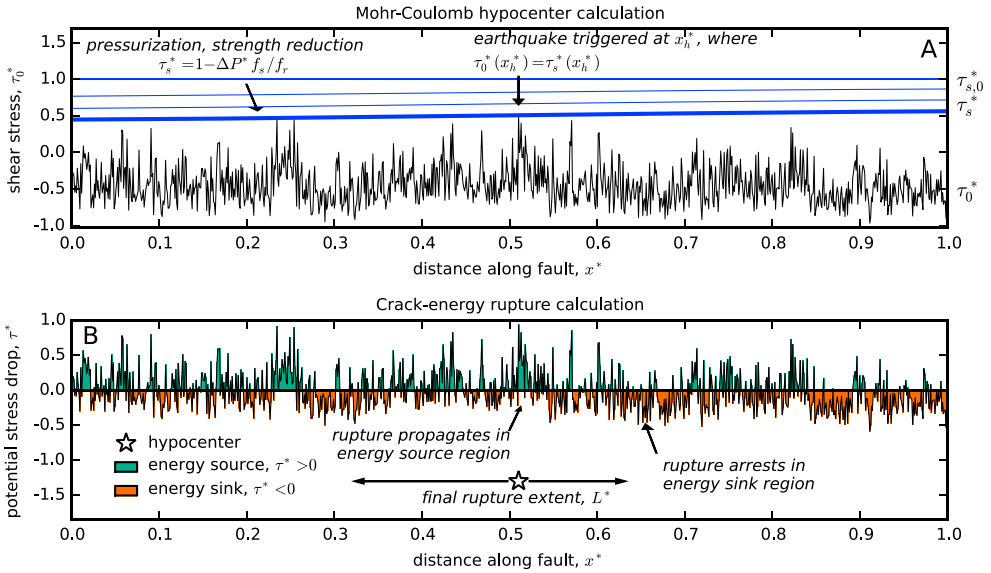



**Figure 6.** Model demonstration of rupture (a) triggering and (b) propagation. In Figure 6a, for heterogeneous shear stress, $\tau_0^*$, successively larger pressure reductions are applied to the static strength ($\tau_s^*$, blue profiles) until an intersection with $\tau_0^*$ occurs—this is the earthquake hypocenter, $x_h^*$, indicated by a star. In Figure 6b left-hand and right-hand crack tips propagate outward from $x_h^*$ along the fault. The locations where they arrest determines the rupture size, $L^*$, and depends on the relative size and width of energy source ($\tau^* > 0$) and sink regions ($\tau^* < 0$). The algorithm used to determine $L^*$ is described in Appendix B.

Formally, stress at location, $x^*$, is a random variable drawn from a Gumbel distribution (18) with mean and standard deviation

$$\mu_\tau^* = \mu_{\tau,0}^* \left(1 - \frac{f_s - f_r}{f_r} \Delta P^*(x^*)\right) - \Delta P^*(x^*), \qquad \sigma_\tau^* = \sigma_{\tau,0}^* \left(1 - \frac{f_s - f_r}{f_r} \Delta P^*(x^*)\right), \tag{22}$$

where $\mu_{\tau,0}^*$ and $\sigma_{\tau,0}^*$ are values for $\Delta P^* = 0$ (Figure 7a). Note, in this formulation, we implicitly assume that the ratio of the dimensional quantities $\mu_\tau / \sigma_\tau$ is preserved; this is assumed to be an intrinsic feature of the stress relaxation process, and its relation to the Gutenberg-Richter *b* value is explored further in the accompanying paper. Discretizing the pressure evolution into discrete steps, $\Delta P_i^*$, we construct a subcatalog of fault realizations for each step, where fault stress reflects $\Delta P_i^*$ (Figure 7b). The complete catalog is a weighted sum of all events in each subcatalog for each $\Delta P_i^*$. The weights for each of *j* events in *i* subcatalogs, $w_{i,j}$, are calculated so that the sum of all event stress drops in a spatiotemporal increment matches the stress change on the fault at that time and location, i.e.,

$$\int_{t_0^*}^{t_1^*} \int_{x_0^*}^{x_1^*} \Delta P^* \mathrm{d}x^* \, \mathrm{d}t^* = \sum_i \sum_j w_{i,j} L_{i,j}^* \Delta \bar{\tau}_{i,j}^* \left(x_0^* \le x_{h,i,j}^* < x_1^*; t_0^* \le t_{h,i,j}^* < t_1^*\right), \tag{23}$$

where $x_0^*$, $x_1^*$, $t_0^*$, and $t_1^*$ define the spatiotemporal increment and $\Delta \bar{\tau}^*$ and $L^*$ are the average stress drop and rupture length of the modeled event.

This approach to modeling stress evolution makes two assumptions: (i) that interactions between subsequent earthquakes can be neglected over large ensembles and (ii) that both *n* and the Gumbel stress PDF (with different $\sigma_\tau^*$ and $\mu_\tau^*$) remain a reasonable model for heterogeneous stress on the evolving fault. One way to test these assumptions would be through deterministic simulation of a large number of earthquakes on a single fault, accounting for stress changes associated with each rupture, e.g., stress concentrations remaining at the rupture tip [*Kammer et al.*, 2015] or heterogeneity arising from geometric complexity [e.g., *Helmstetter and Shaw*, 2006]. In describing the evolving fault stress in average terms, spatiotemporal aftershock clustering is neglected.

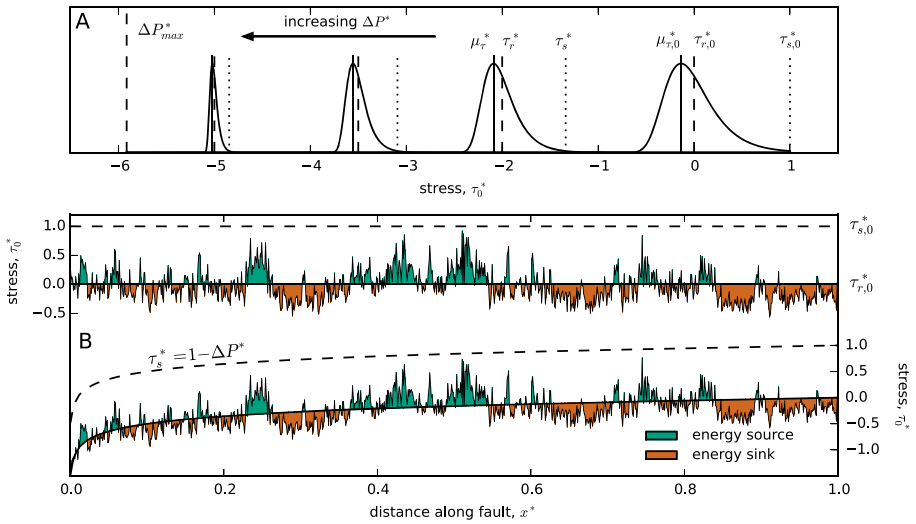



**Figure 7.** An example illustrating construction of an initial stress, $\tau^*_0$, for a subcatalog representing the fault stress state when the pressure buildup distribution, $\Delta P^*$. On the left axes, a realization of $\tau^*_0$ for $\Delta P^* = 0$. Initial static, $\tau^*_{s,0}$, and residual strength, $\tau^*_{r,0}$, are shown as dashed and solid horizontal lines, respectively. On the right axes, the same stress state is shown modified to account for nonzero $\Delta P^*$ (in this case, a pressure profile for injection into a 2-D geometry).

## 3. Directivity Properties of Tectonic Earthquakes

In this section, we discuss simulation and analysis of catalog TR0 (Tectonic Reference) which approximates background seismicity triggered by tectonic plate motion. Catalog TR0 serves as a benchmark for when we later compare modeled catalogs of tectonic and induced earthquakes. Furthermore, we can compare the range of directivity ratios, $D$, for modeled earthquakes to that obtained from seismological observations.

Catalog TR0 is constructed from a single earthquake simulated on each of $10^5$ faults. Each fault has a different realization of heterogeneous stress, $\tau^*_0$, constructed from the same parameterization of the fractal stress model. Friction parameters are the same for all earthquake calculations. TR0 is an approximation of a real earthquake catalog, which might comprise a population of events on faults of different sizes ($L_0$) sometimes from regions that may have different stress ($n$, $\mu^*_\tau$, $\sigma^*_\tau$) or friction properties ($f_r$, $f_s$, $\Gamma^*$). We could replicate these conditions by mixing earthquakes modeled on faults of different sizes or parameters; however, this is an unnecessary step for the present study. In contrast to simulated catalogs of induced earthquakes considered later, TR0 is not constructed as an ensemble sum of faults with different stress states (section 2.6.1). This is because we consider tectonic fault stress as quasi-steady, i.e., an average over the seismic cycle.

### 3.1. Model Parameterization

We use a rate-and-state friction model to estimate values for the friction coefficients $f_s$ and $f_r$, and the fracture energy, $\Gamma^*$. Laboratory sliding experiments reveal that rock friction evolves during the seismic cycle with a direct dependence on the sliding velocity as well as an evolutionary "state" effect [*Dieterich and Kilgore*, 1996; *Marone*, 1998]. The rate-and-state friction model with slip law evolution of the state variable can be written as

$$f = A \ln\left(\frac{V}{V_0}\right) + \theta, \qquad \theta_{ss} = f_0 - B \ln\left(\frac{V}{V_0}\right), \qquad \dot{\theta} = -\frac{V}{D_c}\left(\theta - \theta_{ss}(V)\right) \tag{24}$$

where $f$ is friction, $V$ is slip velocity, $\theta$ is the state variable with steady value $\theta_{ss}$, $A$, and $B$ are the direct effect and state evolution parameters, $D_c$ is the critical slip distance, and $f_0$ and $V_0$ are reference values of friction and velocity. Following *Dunham et al.* [2011], we approximate $f_s$ as the steady state value of friction at low slip velocity

$$f_s = f_0 + (A - B) \ln\left(\frac{V_{\min}}{V_0}\right), \tag{25}$$

where $V_{\min}$ is the background slip velocity. During an earthquake, friction drops to a steady state value for the coseismic slip rate, $V_{\max}$. This defines residual friction

$$f_r = f_0 + (A - B) \ln\left(\frac{V_{\max}}{V_0}\right). \tag{26}$$

At the front of a propagating rupture, there is a rapid increase in friction (and shear stress) due to the direct velocity effect followed by the drop to $f_r$. Allowing for pressure change, $\Delta P^*$, the maximum potential stress drop attained, $\tau_p^*$, as the rupture front passes a point is given

$$\tau_p^* = \tau_0^* + \frac{f_p}{f_s - f_r} - \frac{f_p}{f_r}\Delta P^*, \qquad f_p = A \ln\left(\frac{V_{\max}}{V_{\min}}\right), \tag{27}$$

where $f_p$ is the friction change corresponding to shear stress increase at the rupture front.

Defining the fracture energy for a rate-and-state friction model in terms of the drop from peak to residual strength [*Rice*, 1983], we then have

$$\Gamma^* = D_c^*\left(\tau_0^* + \frac{f_p}{f_s - f_r} + \left(1 - \frac{f_p}{f_r}\right)\Delta P^*\right). \tag{28}$$

Taking $A - B = -0.004$, $A = 0.015$, $D_c = 10^{-5}$ m, $f_0 = 0.6$, $V_0 = 10^{-6}$ m s$^{-1}$, $V_{\max} = 10^0$ m s$^{-1}$, and $V_{\min} = 10^{-10}$ m s$^{-1}$ [*Rice*, 1993] yields $f_s = 0.64$, $f_r = 0.55$, and $f_p = 0.35$.

Friction coefficients are multiplied by effective normal stress, $\sigma_n - P_0$, to yield fault strength. We estimate $\sigma_n - P_0$ for a well-oriented strike-slip fault buried at a depth of 4 km. Assuming hydrostatic fluid pressure and an average crustal density of $\rho = 2500$ kg m$^{-3}$, the effective intermediate principal stress (lithostatic minus hydrostatic) at this depth is vertical and approximately 60 MPa. Assuming this stress lies halfway between the other two horizontal principal stresses, then for a fault with $f_s = 0.64$, the optimal orientation for reactivation is ~30° to the maximum principal stress. At this orientation, $\sigma_n - P_0$ is approximately 40 MPa.

In the companion paper, we derive a magnitude estimate, $M_w$, for modeled events in terms of rupture length, $L^*$, and average stress drop, $\Delta\bar{\tau}$. The magnitude scale is calibrated such that rupture of the entire fault corresponds to an $M_w$ 4.5 event, which is within the range of interest for induced seismicity. We then constrain parameters of the fractal stress model by requiring that the magnitude-frequency distribution for catalog TR0 be consistent with seismological observation, i.e., conforming to a Gutenberg-Richter model with a $b$ value of 1.15. For the simulations in this paper, we fix fractal exponent, $n = 0.25$, stress PDF standard deviation, $\sigma_\tau^* = 0.225$, and $\mu_\tau^* = -0.54$.

In implementing the model, we represent the heterogeneous shear stress profile that spans the length of the fault as a vector with 1024 nodes and require that modeled ruptures span at least five nodes. Since our model does not require time integration or the computation of numerical derivatives, the fault discretization does not affect the accuracy of our results, only the resolution of directivity ratio for small events.

### 3.2. Directivity Ratio

The distribution of directivity ratios, $D$, for all events in catalog TR0 is summarized in Figure 8a. We represent the set of all directivity ratios as a PDF across the permitted range, [−1,1], to enable a comparison between samples of different sizes. Also shown is the directivity ratio PDF compiled by *McGuire et al.* [2002] from 42 large, shallow earthquakes. Because directivity ratios given in *McGuire et al.* [2002] are unsigned (sign is only meaningful when considering more than one rupture on a fault), it is equally valid to compare against either positive or negative directivities in Figure 8a. To illustrate this point, we compare observations and the model for both cases (to compare against the model for $D < 0$, the observations of *McGuire et al.* [2002] are assigned a negative sign, grey symbols in Figure 8a).

The distributions in Figure 8a are peaked at $D = -1$ and 1 with a minimum around zero, although the modeled directivity PDF is not as strongly unilateral as the observations of *McGuire et al.* [2002]. The modeled directivity PDF is symmetric about zero in agreement with an assumed symmetric tectonic loading condition that imparts no bias toward forward or backward directed rupture.

We obtain an estimate of the catalog size required for accurate representation of directivity PDFs through a convergence test. We first construct a test catalog from a subset of events randomly sampled from catalog TR0. We then compute a directivity PDF for the test catalog and calculate the relative error against the PDF for the complete catalog for $D = 0$ and $D = 0.95$ (Figure 8b). The error decays according to $1/\sqrt{N}$ for sample size $N$. For catalogs comprising 10,000 events, the relative error is small, ranging from 2 to 5%. Errors are smallest at the $D = -1$ and 1 peaks of the PDF, and it is this section of the distribution that we are most interested in.

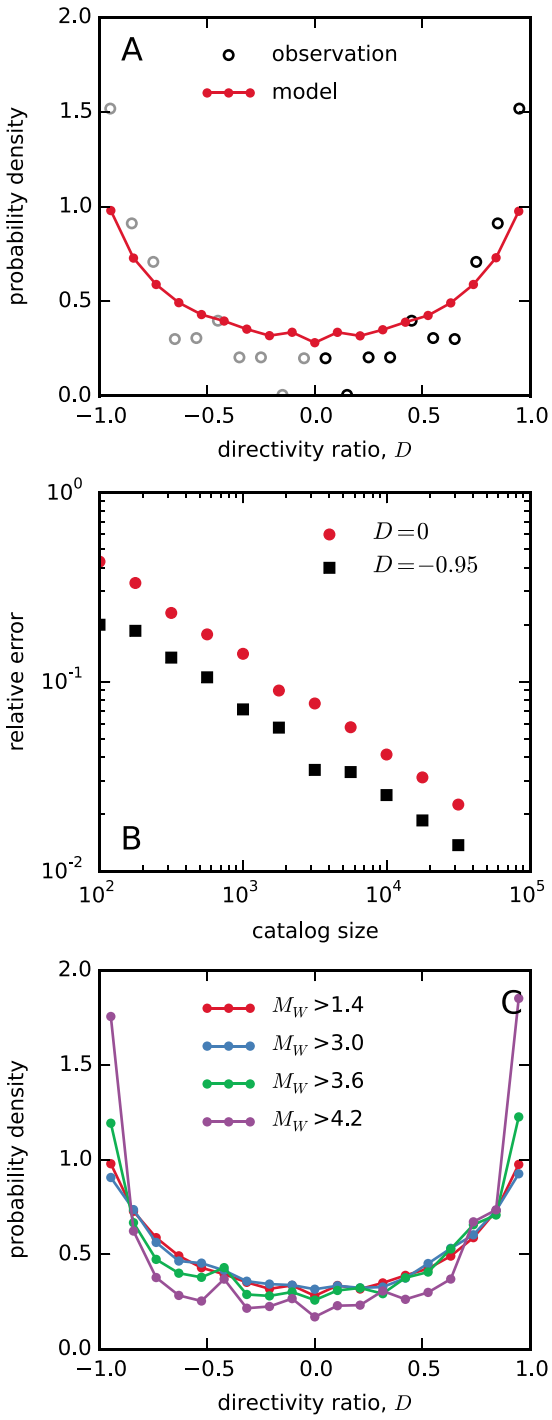



**Figure 8.** (a) Directivity ratio PDF for all events in catalog TR0 (red) and for 42 earthquakes summarized in *McGuire et al.* [2002] (open circles). Note, for illustrative purposes, the *McGuire et al.* [2002] data are also shown for $D$ <0 (grey symbols), which involves assigning a negative sign to their data. (b) Convergence of the modeled PDF in Figure 8a for different catalog sizes at $D = 0$ and $D = 0.95$. (c) Directivity ratio PDFs for different magnitude cutoffs.

The directivity PDF is consistent in its shape across the modeled range of magnitudes (Figure 8c). For larger modeled earthquakes, however, the directivity PDF shows higher peaks at $D = -1$ and 1, consistent with the *McGuire et al.* [2002] observations and indicative of a preference for unilateral rupture.

### 3.3. Approximate Form for the Directivity Ratio PDF

A second measure of rupture directivity is the proportion unilateral rupture, $E$, defined in (2) as a linear function of the hypocentral location inside the ruptured area, $\alpha$. Figure 9a plots a PDF of both $\alpha$ and $E$. The PDF for $\alpha$ has a maximum at 0.5 (the center of the rupture) and the distribution is symmetric about this point. *Mai et al.* [2005] analyze the hypocentral locations of 51 earthquakes with finite source models. Their data are also shown in Figure 9a. Using a Kolmogorov-Smirnov test, they reject a null hypothesis that their observations of $\alpha$ are drawn from a uniform distribution. Instead, they fit a Gaussian distribution and obtain a best fit standard deviation of 0.23.

Note, although the PDF of $\alpha$ is peaked at 0.5, this does not imply that most ruptures are bilateral. There is a nonlinear relationship between $\alpha$ and the directivity ratio, $D$, such that even small deviations of $\alpha$ from 0.5 result in a large shift toward unilateral rupture.

We obtain an approximate description of the directivity ratio PDF, $P_D(D)$, by a change of variable in the hypocentral location distribution, $P_\alpha(\alpha)$. An approximate form for $P_D$ is later useful for applying statistical tests to detect directivity bias in a catalog of induced earthquakes. For $D(\alpha)$ defined in (3) and inverse denoted $\alpha(D)$, the change of variable is given

$$P_D(D) = \left|\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}D}(\alpha(D))\right| P_\alpha(\alpha(D)). \qquad (29)$$

We approximate $D(\alpha)$ with a logistic curve of the form

$$D = c_1\left[\frac{2}{1+e^{c_2\left(\alpha-\frac{1}{2}\right)}}-1\right], \qquad (30)$$

where we choose parameters $c_1$ and $c_2$ to yield the least squares best fit with equation (3) on the interval $\alpha$=[0, 1]. Figure 9b compares the theoretical function equation (3) to the best fit logistic curve equation (30) with $c_1 = 1.01$ and $c_2 = 11.67$.

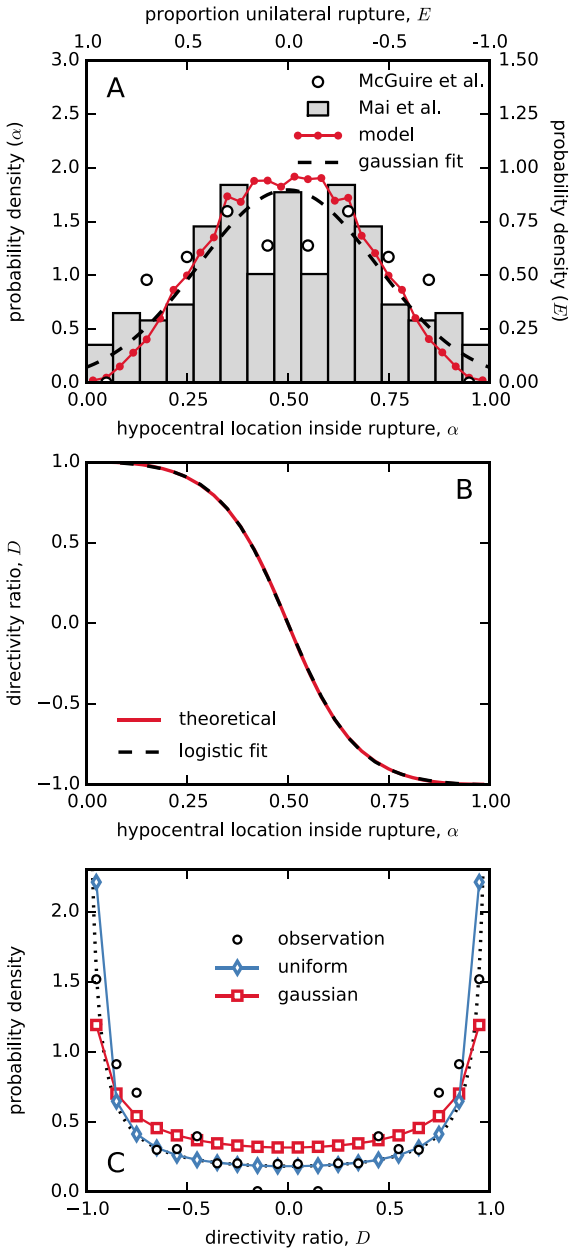



**Figure 9.** (a) PDFs of hypocentral location inside rupture, including data from *McGuire et al.* [2002] (open circles) inverted using (30), best fit Gaussian curve to *McGuire et al.* [2002] data (black dashed curve), data from *Mai et al.* [2005] (bars), and catalog TR0 (red curve). (b) Relationship between directivity ratio, $D$, and normalized hypocentral location inside rupture, $\alpha$, for the simple 1-D rupture model in equation (3). The best fit logistic curve (30) with $c_1 = 1.01$ and $c_2 = 11.67$ is also shown (black dashed curve). (c) Directivity ratio PDFs, including data from *McGuire et al.* [2002] (open circles), and two theoretical PDFs assuming either a uniform (blue diamonds) or Gaussian PDF (red squares) for $\alpha$. For comparison against the *McGuire et al.* [2002] data, markers plot average function value for the corresponding bin. The standard deviation of the Gaussian PDF is 0.22 and is obtained by a maximum likelihood fit against the *McGuire et al.* [2002] data and corresponds to the black dashed curve in Figure 9a.

For $P_\alpha$, we assume a Gaussian distribution, as suggested by *Mai et al.* [2005] and consistent with the modeled distribution of $\alpha$ shown in Figure 9a. From symmetry, we assume a mean of 0.5 in which case $P_\alpha$ is given

$$P_\alpha = \frac{\gamma}{\sigma_\alpha \sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\left[ -\frac{\left(\alpha - \frac{1}{2}\right)^2}{2\sigma_\alpha^2} \right], \quad (31)$$

where $\gamma$ normalizes $P_\alpha$ on the interval $\alpha = [0, 1]$ and $\sigma_\alpha$ is the distribution standard deviation. Using (30) and (31) in (29), we obtain the directivity ratio PDF as

$$P_D = \frac{\gamma}{c_1 \tilde{\sigma}} \sqrt{\frac{2}{\pi}} \frac{1}{1 - \tilde{D}^2} \exp\left[ -\frac{\ln^2\left(\frac{1-\tilde{D}}{1+\tilde{D}}\right)}{2\tilde{\sigma}^2} \right], \quad (32)$$

and associated cumulative distribution function

$$F_D = \frac{\gamma}{2} \mathrm{erfc}\left[ \frac{\ln\left(\frac{1-\tilde{D}}{1+\tilde{D}}\right)}{\sqrt{2}\tilde{\sigma}_\alpha} \right], \quad (33)$$

where $\tilde{D} = D/c_1$, $\tilde{\sigma}_\alpha = \sigma_\alpha c_2$ and erfc denotes the complementary error function. We estimate $\sigma_\alpha$ by maximizing the log likelihood, $\ell$, generated from the 42 observations of directivity ratio, $D_i$, given in *McGuire et al.* [2002]

$$\ell = \sum_i \ln P_D(D_i | \sigma_\alpha), \quad (34)$$

which yields $\sigma_\alpha = 0.22$, in close agreement with $\sigma_\alpha = 0.23$ estimated by *Mai et al.* [2005]. Using this estimate for $\sigma_\alpha$, we obtain a good match to the modeled $P_\alpha$ for catalog TR0 (Figure 9a). We also compute $P_D$ and compare this against the observations of *McGuire et al.* [2002]. In Figure 9c, we show $P_D$ for a uniform hypocentral location PDF (setting $P_\alpha = 1$), which compares to Figure 7 in *McGuire et al.* [2002].

The analysis presented in this section assumes uniform loading of the fault and this is reflected in $P_D$ as symmetry about $D = 0$. However, nonuniform loading could occur at the boundary of creeping and locked sections of a fault [e.g., *Lapusta et al.*, 2000] or on locked asperities, and this could introduce a directivity bias specific to the fault. In addition, it has been suggested that some

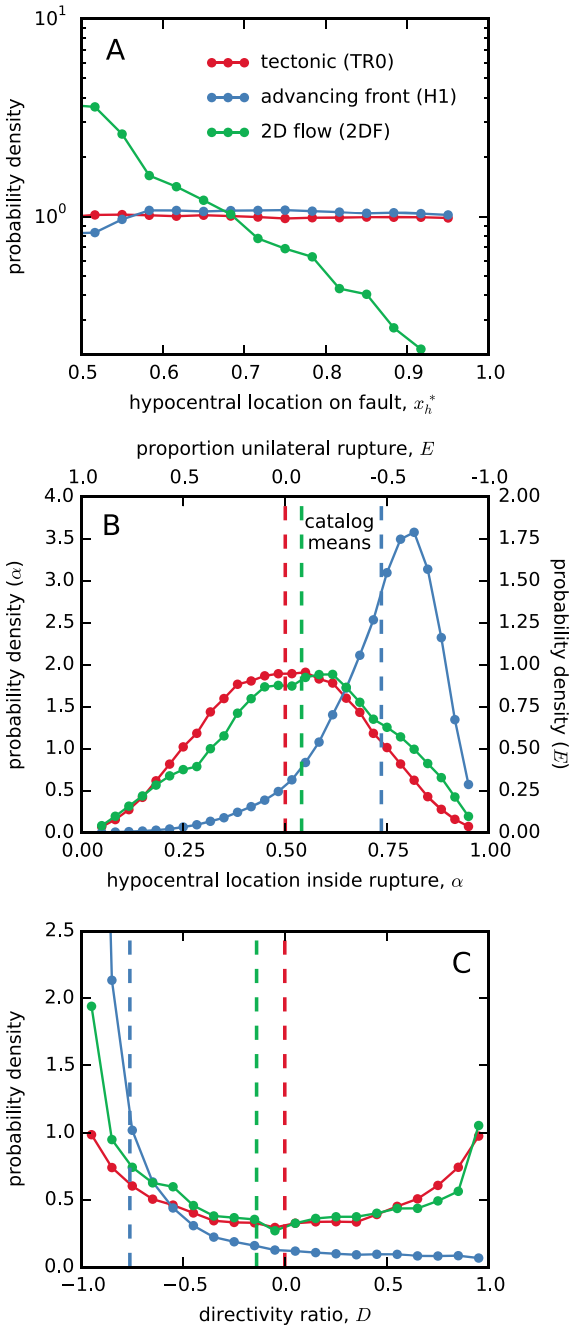



**Figure 10.** PDF comparisons between simulated catalogs TR0, H1, and 2DF. (a) PDF of hypocentral location on the fault, $x_h^*$ (note, $\Delta P^*$ is symmetrical about $x^* = 0.5$ and so only half the fault is shown). (b) PDF of hypocentral location inside the rupture, $\alpha$, and the corresponding PDF for proportion unilateral rupture, $E$. Catalog means are indicated by dashed lines. Note, because $E$ is linearly related to $\alpha$ (equation (2)), their PDFs are a linear scaling of one another and can be represented on the same plot. (c) PDFs of directivity ratio, $D$. The point at $D \sim -1$ for catalog H1 (not shown) is 7.6.

faults may have a preferred direction of rupture propagation due to bimaterial interface effects [*Ben-Zion*, 2001] and this too would be expected to modify the form of $P_D$. Nevertheless, the consistency of (32) with observations of directivity ratio (albeit, compiled for earthquakes on different faults) suggests that the approximation may be reasonable to first order. In addition, the ability of a simple 1-D fracture mechanics model to reproduce the observed directivity distribution for 2-D rupture indicates that (i) the model adequately approximates rupture physics and (ii) conclusions drawn from simulations of 1-D induced ruptures presented in the next section may be extended, at least qualitatively, to induced earthquakes on 2-D faults.

## 4. Directivity Bias of Induced Earthquake Sequences

In this section, we discuss the construction and analysis of earthquake catalogs in which modeled events are triggered by an evolving pressure distribution on the fault. We consider first seismicity associated with injection directly onto a fault, with pressure evolution given by the limiting cases of 2-D flow, which assumes no permeability enhancement (catalog 2DF, $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}} = 0.74$, $\mu^*_\tau = -0.54$, open boundaries) and the two-value advancing front, which assumes a large permeability enhancement (catalog H1, $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}} = 0.74$, $\mu^*_\tau = -0.81$). Catalogs are constructed according to the method in section 2.6 with all other simulation parameters the same as TR0.

In contrast to the uniform distribution of TR0, for catalog 2DF, more events are triggered closer to the injection well because this is the location of highest pressure (Figure 10a). In addition, the distribution of hypocentral locations inside each rupture, $\alpha$ (Figure 10b), is no longer symmetric about 0.5: induced earthquakes are more likely to be triggered on the side of the rupture furthest from the injection well. As a result, the proportion of unilateral rupture, $E$, is shifted in favor of backward directed rupture (rupture traveling toward the injection well). The PDFs for directivity ratio, $D$, show an accentuated peak at $D \sim -1$ (Figure 10c). The average values of $D$ and $E$ experience a negative shift. For the remainder of this paper, we use the average directivity ratio, $\bar{D}$, as a quantitative measure of directivity bias. Catalog H1 presents similar results to 2DF except that there is a much stronger negative shift in $\bar{D}$ (and accompanying shifts in the distribution of $\alpha$).

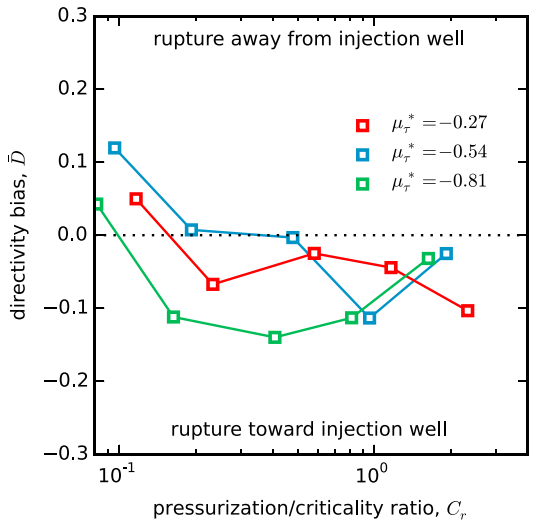



**Figure 11.** Dependence of directivity bias, $\bar{D}$, for simulated catalogs in a 2-D flow geometry and varying pressurization/criticality ratios, $C_r$. The color of the markers indicates the initial fault stress, as parameterized by $\mu_\tau^*$.

For a 2-D flow geometry, we consider how directivity bias varies for a range of injection pressure, $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$, and initial fault stress, parameterized by $\mu_\tau^*$ (Figure 11). Both the amount of pressure rise and the proximity of the fault to failure are relevant quantities, and we therefore introduce the nondimensional pressurization/criticality ratio

$$C_r = \Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}/(1 - \mu_\tau^*), \tag{35}$$

which scales the injection pressure by how close on average the fault is to failing. Directivity bias is relatively small (compared to catalog H1) and variable across a range of $C_r$ but tends to be more negative for low stress faults and high-pressure injection. Positive directivity bias occurs for injection at very low pressure.

Negative directivity bias indicates a preference for rupture back toward the injection well. This occurs because of the favorable conditions for rupture to continue propagating while it is inside the high-pressure zone around the well. *McClure and Horne* [2011] identify similar behavior in their model of induced seismicity. Figure 12d illustrates schematically how such rupture conditions are improved by depression of the residual strength, $\tau_r^*$, in the near vicinity of a well. We also suggest a second scenario (Figure 12c) that may account for positive directivity bias at low $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$. This requires that the pressure disturbance plays a larger role in triggering earthquakes than in modifying the energetics of rupture. However, for the parameters we have investigated, this scenario is infrequent and results only in a weak directivity bias.

For earthquakes triggered by the advancing front, generally, there is a strong negative directivity bias across a range of $\Delta P^*$ and $\mu_\tau^*$ (Figure 13a). The curves for each value of $\mu_\tau^*$ exhibit a characteristic variation with increasing $\Delta P^*$: $\bar{D}$, is initially between 0.4 and 0.6; it becomes more negative, approaches a minimum, climbs to a peak at $C_r \approx 1$ and then declines again. The initial variation can be understood in energy terms: directivity bias arises due to preferred rupture conditions inside the plume than outside. Preference for rupture is expressed in terms of average potential stress drop, which is $\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{in}} \approx \mu_\tau^* + \Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$ inside the plume and $\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{out}} \approx \mu_\tau^*$ outside. The directivity bias is stronger when the ratio of these two quantities, i.e., $\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{in}}/\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{out}} = \Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}/\mu_\tau^* + 1$, is larger. A strengthening directivity bias occurs as $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$ initially increases (with $\mu_\tau^*$ fixed) and sometimes for decreasing $\mu_\tau^*$. Thus, if sufficiently well constrained, the directivity bias might serve as an approximate indication of fault criticality.

As $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$ continues to increase, earthquakes triggered by the advancing front are, on average, triggered with a smaller advancement of the pressure front (e.g., compare Figure 12c and 12d). The size of the region of enhanced $\tau^*_{\text{in}}$ (approximated by $L^*$) is smaller and thus so are modeled earthquakes. Smaller magnitude events exhibit a weaker directivity bias (e.g., magnitude sensitivity of 2-D flow simulations is shown in Figure 8c), and so $\bar{D}$ increases. This reaches an extreme when $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$ is so large as to be of the order of the fault proximity to failure ($C_r \approx 1$), in which case the front advances a small distance and then triggers a small event.

Clearly, $\bar{D}$ is determined by the trade-off between increasing $\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{in}}/\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{out}}$ and decreasing $L^*$, such that there is a particular value of $\Delta P^*_{\text{inj}}$ at which the modeled directivity bias is strongest. For $C_r > 1$, directivity bias increases in strength with increasing $C_r$. This is because average $L^*$ cannot decrease any further, whereas the ratio $\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{in}}/\bar{\tau}^*_{\text{out}}$ can continue to increase.

Simulated directivity bias is typically quite weak for the extended 2-D geometry (Figure 13c). Directivity bias becomes more negative with increasing injection pressure consistent with the schematic illustrations in Figure 12.

A preference for ruptures to propagate back toward (and sometimes across) the injection well was identified in the simulations of *McClure and Horne* [2011]. Permeability evolution in those models resulted in a distribution

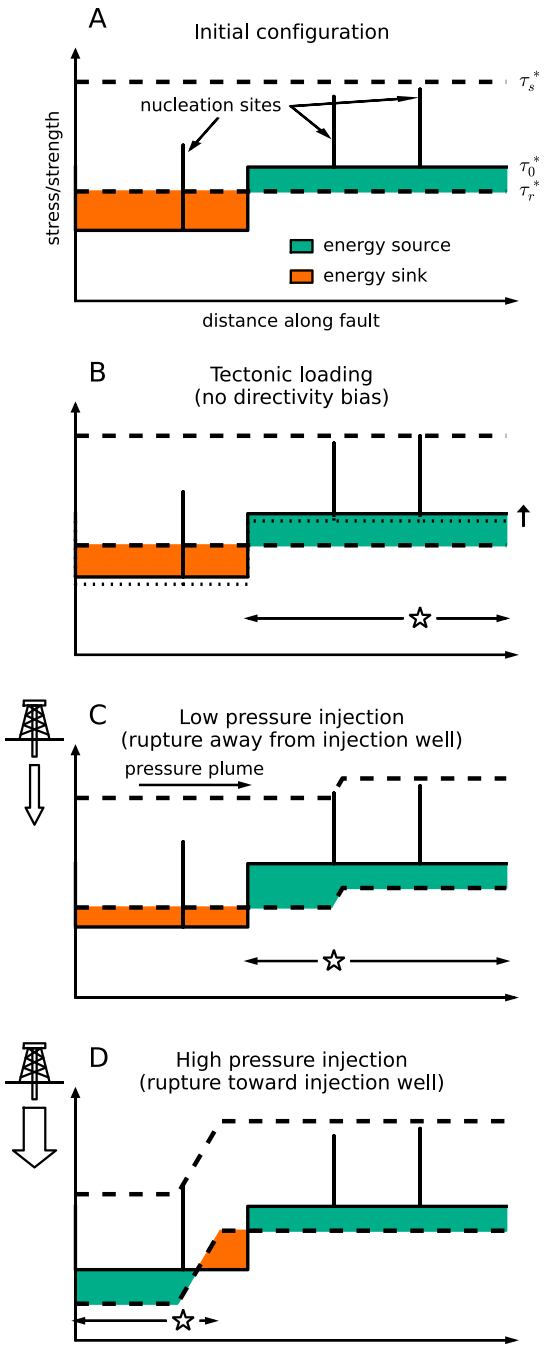



**Figure 12.** Injection and rupture schematics illustrating the interaction of a pressure plume and a fault with heterogeneous stress producing forward and backward directivity bias. (a) Initial configuration of strength (dashed lines) and stress (solid line) and energy source (green) and sink regions (orange). Three potential nucleation sites are indicated. (b) When tectonic loading is applied, rupture nucleates at the highest stress location (star) and propagates within the contiguous energy source region (arrows). (c) When loading is due to a low pressure plume, rupture nucleates at a different location to Figure 12b but propagates within the same region. (d) When loading is due to a high-pressure plume, a new energy source region is created and rupture propagation is restricted to it. Note, for simplicity, the plumes in Figures 12c and 12d have the appearance of an advancing front (Figures 4e and 4f).

of pressure that resembles the advancing front. For catalog H1, which employs the advancing front, approximately 7% of the simulated ruptures propagated back across the injection well.

We have demonstrated a negative directivity bias for earthquakes induced by injection directly into a 1-D fault. This bias originates from favorable modification of the energetics of rupture near the injection well. For ruptures on 2-D faults, a similar result is expected because (i) creation of a high-pressure region about the injection well is independent of problem dimension and (ii) the creation of favorable rupture conditions inside this region is due to an increase of the potential stress drop, $\tau^*$, an energy-based argument that is valid in 2-D.

### 4.1. Detecting Directivity Bias

In Figure 10c, we compare the directivity of tectonic and induced events. To formalize the comparison, we apply a Kolmogorov-Smirnov (KS) test. Suppose we have made a set of directivity measurements and we would like to test the null hypothesis that the measurements are consistent with an underlying tectonic directivity distribution (Figure 9c). If the observations are incompatible, this may indicate that the events are not tectonic in origin or, alternatively, that (32) is not a good model of tectonic events on the fault. The KS test outputs a $p$ value, which, if less than 0.05, we consider sufficient evidence to reject the null hypothesis. A random sample of $N$ events is drawn from a simulated catalog—these represent the observations—and the KS test applied. This process is repeated 2000 times to determine the average $p$ value for sample size, $N$. Assuming that directivity ratio measurements might be more readily available for large magnitude events, we repeat the procedure considering just those catalog events above a magnitude cutoff.

For catalog H1, which exhibited the stronger directivity bias of the two induced catalogs shown in Figure 10, the null hypothesis is rejected after as few as three observations (Figure 14). For catalog 2DF, the directivity bias is less pronounced. When considering all catalog events, the null hypothesis is not rejected even with 100 observations. However, as we noted in the previous section, $\bar{D}$ is

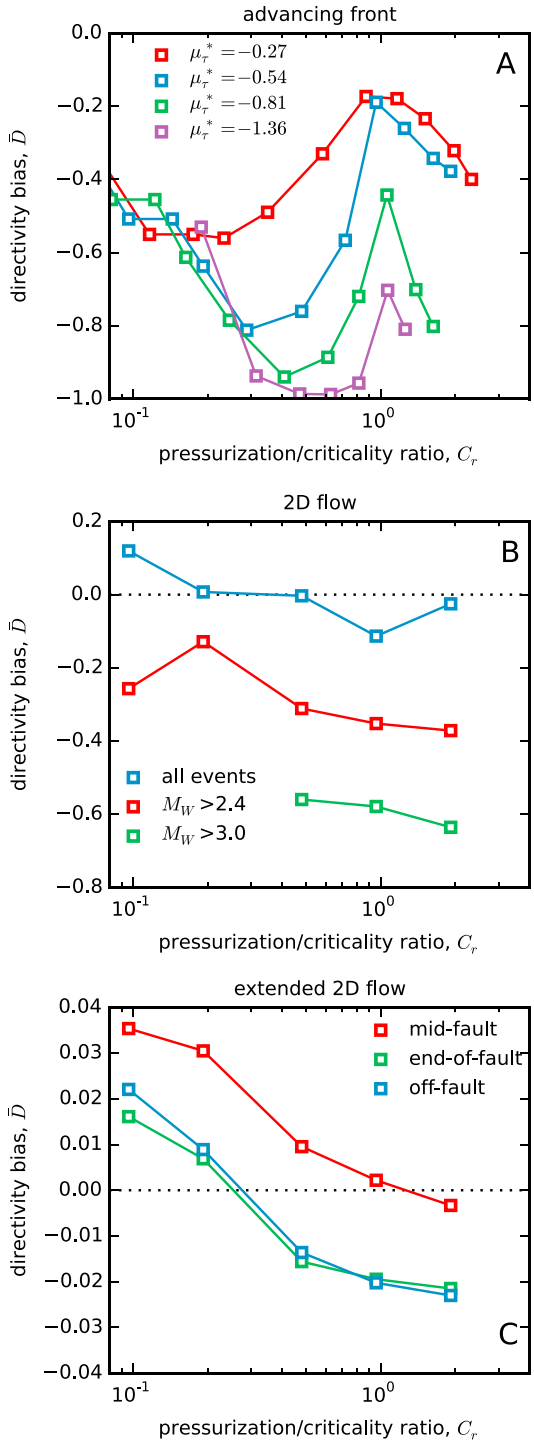



**Figure 13.** Directivity bias, $\bar{D}$, versus pressurization/criticality ratio, $C_r$, for a range of model parameters and catalog subsets: (a) two-value advancing front (Figures 4e and 4f), (b) magnitude cutoff (for 2-D flow and fixing $\mu_\tau^* = -0.54$), and (c) extended 2-D flow geometry, varying injection well position (Figures 5e and 5f), and fixing $\mu_\tau^* = -0.54$.

stronger for large magnitude events (Figure 13a). Restricting the test to events larger than an arbitrary cutoff of $M_w$ 2.4 reduces the number of required observations to 20. This is fortunate, as directivity measurements are easier to obtain for large magnitude events for which there is a greater likelihood of resolving a finite source time function (as required by the calculation in Appendix A).

Despite the success of the KS test in identifying directivity bias in catalogs H1 and 2DF, several limitations should be noted. We have assumed that a symmetrical directivity PDF is a reasonable null hypothesis. Symmetry is certainly a feature of the modeled tectonic directivity PDF (e.g., Figures 8c and 8a), but our model does not include the relevant physics that would introduce directivity bias under uniform tectonic loading. For example, a preferred rupture propagation direction has been suggested for faults with a bimaterial interface [*Ben-Zion*, 2001; *Ampuero and Ben-Zion*, 2008] such as might occur on plate-bounding faults with large accumulated slip. Several studies of the San Andreas fault [*Lengliné and Got*, 2011; *Zaliapin and Ben-Zion*, 2011; *Kane et al.*, 2013] have tentatively established the presence of a directivity bias in the expected direction, although the study of *Zaliapin and Ben-Zion* [2011] indicates it is not a feature common to all faults. Additionally, if loading on a fault is nonuniform, for example, at the boundary of creeping and locked sections of a fault [e.g., *Lapusta et al.*, 2000], then some systematic bias may exist in the natural events. The assumption of symmetry in the null hypothesis, and the breaking of that symmetry in directivity observations, underpins the KS test presented here. If tectonic symmetry is absent, then the KS test could provide an incorrect indication of induced seismicity.

The assumption of tectonic symmetry may also not be appropriate for dip-slip faulting, where the presence of a free surface and basal boundary condition might introduce asymmetry into the hypocentral location distribution and directivity PDF. For instance, *Mai et al.* [2005] considered downdip hypocentral locations for 47 earthquakes and fitted the data with asymmetric Weibull and Gamma distributions. Depending on style of faulting, the fitted distributions had means between 0.4 and 0.6 and showed central tendency. Applying the KS test to directivity observations from dip-slip earthquakes that

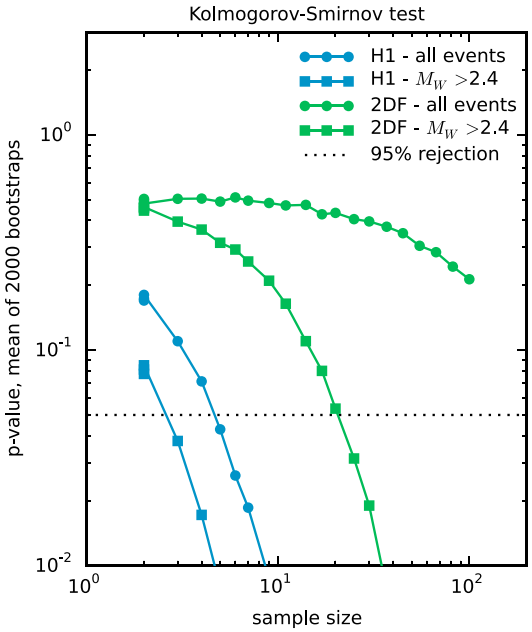



**Figure 14.** Summary of Kolmogorov-Smirnov (KS) testing to establish the presence of a directivity bias in catalogs H1 (blue) and 2DF (green symbols). The KS test is performed against the cumulative PDF for the tectonic directivity ratio given by equation (33). Random samples are drawn from either H1 or 2DF (see Figure 10) either with (circles) or without (squares) an $M_w$ >2.4 cutoff. The average $p$ value of the KS test is plotted for 2000 bootstrap samples at each sample size. The dotted line is the $p$ value for rejection of the null hypothesis at a 95% level of confidence.

are suspected of being induced would first require better constraint of $P_D$ appropriate for natural dip-slip earthquakes.

## 5. Conclusion

We have introduced a model for simulating large catalogs of tectonic and injection-induced earthquakes on 1-D faults with fractal stress heterogeneity. Earthquake triggering is assessed using the Mohr-Coulomb criterion, which is satisfied either by tectonically driven shear stress increase or a nonuniform strength reduction by increasing pressure on a fault (section 2.4). The length of a fault rupture is calculated based on a fracture mechanics description of the bilateral crack propagation problem (section 2.2.2). Earthquake catalogs modeled under a tectonic loading condition demonstrate a preference for unilateral rupture, consistent with seismological observations (section 3). Direction of rupture is quantified by the directivity ratio, $D$, whose sign indicates whether rupture is toward (negative) or away from (positive) an injection well. The average value of $D$ in a catalog of earthquakes defines the directivity bias. For tectonic earthquakes, the simulated directivity bias is zero, although bimaterial effects or nonuniform loading rates could modify this on some faults.

The main difference between simulations of tectonic earthquakes and two end-member scenarios of injection directly onto a fault—2-D radial flow with constant permeability and a two-value advancing front (approximating permeability enhancement)—is a tendency for negative directivity bias in the induced earthquakes (section 4). This arises due to relatively favorable conditions for continuing rupture propagation in the high-pressure region near an injection well. The strongest bias occurs for the advancing front as this imposes the largest pressure rise in the region between the earthquake hypocenter and the well. The modeled directivity bias is stronger for larger magnitude events and is very weak when injection occurs away from a fault (e.g., the extended 2-D flow geometry that approximates wastewater injection).

Directivity bias is strongest, and therefore most easily detected, for earthquake sequences triggered by an advancing pressure front, such as has been suggested for EGS stimulation [*Gischig and Wiemer*, 2013; *Miller*, 2015]. Efforts to detect such bias should focus on the larger magnitude events, which tend to depart more strongly from an unbiased tectonic directivity distribution. For example, *Jonas et al.* [2015] provide an analysis of the rupture direction of three of the larger events triggered during the Basel EGS stimulation. These events appear to have nucleated at the edge of the stimulation volume and propagated back toward injection well, which is consistent with the tendency for negative directivity bias that arises in our model for high-pressure injection into a fault.

## Appendix A: Directivity of 1-D Fault Ruptures

Consider a 1-D fault of length, $L_0$, oriented along the $x$ axis. An earthquake rupture nucleates on the fault at position, $x_h$, at time $t = 0$ and two rupture fronts propagate at constant velocity, $v$, away from $x_h$. The front traveling in the $-x$ direction reaches the end of the fault and terminates at time, $t_- = x_h/v$, while the front traveling in the $+x$ direction terminates at time, $t_+ = (L_0 - x_h)/v$. We consider a simple scenario in which the

final moment release is constant along the fault, in which case the moment release rate is given

$$\dot{M} = \frac{M_0 v \dot{f}(x,t)}{L_0}, \tag{A1}$$

where $M_0$ is the total moment release and $\dot{f}$ encapsulates the spatiotemporal component of $\dot{M}$. All slip is assumed to occur instantaneously at the rupture front and therefore $\dot{f}$ is described by two delta functions

$$\dot{f}(x,t) = \delta_-\left(x - x_h + vt\right) + \delta_+\left(x - x_h - vt\right), \tag{A2}$$

where the delta function subscripts $\pm$ indicate that integrals over time should be truncated to $t_\pm$, respectively. Note that the moment release function has been defined such that its zeroth moment equals the total moment release

$$\frac{M_0 v}{L_0}\int_V \int_0^\infty \dot{f}(x,t)\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}t = M_0. \tag{A3}$$

Following *Backus* [1977], the spatial and temporal centroids, $x_0$ and $t_0$, are given as

$$x_0 = \frac{1}{M_0}\int_V \int_0^\infty x\dot{M}(x,t)\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{L_0}{2}, \tag{A4}$$

$$t_0 = \frac{1}{M_0}\int_V \int_0^\infty t\dot{M}(x,t)\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{2x_h^2 - 2L_0 x_h + L_0^2}{2L_0 v}. \tag{A5}$$

Following *McGuire et al.* [2002], we define second-order moments of $\dot{M}$ in space ($\hat{\mu}^{(2,0)}$), time ($\hat{\mu}^{(0,2)}$), and a mixed moment ($\hat{\mu}^{(1,1)}$), given as

$$\hat{\mu}^{(2,0)} = \frac{1}{M_0}\int_V \int_0^\infty (x - x_0)^2\dot{M}(x,t)\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{L_0^2}{12}, \tag{A6}$$

$$\hat{\mu}^{(1,1)} = \frac{1}{M_0}\int_V \int_0^\infty (x - x_0)(t - t_0)\dot{M}(x,t)\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{1}{12L_0^2 v}\left(L_0^4 - 6x_h^2 L_0^2 + 4x_h^3 L_0\right), \tag{A7}$$

$$\hat{\mu}^{(0,2)} = \frac{1}{M_0}\int_V \int_0^\infty (t - t_0)^2\dot{M}(x,t)\,\mathrm{d}x\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{1}{12L_0^2 v^2}\left(L_0^4 - 12x_h^2 L_0^2 + 24x_h^3 L_0 - 12x_h^4\right), \tag{A8}$$

where the superscripts $(m, n)$ indicates that $m$ moments have been taken about $x_0$ and $n$ about $t_0$.

Dimensionally, the moments $\hat{\mu}^{(2,0)}$, $\hat{\mu}^{(1,1)}$, and $\hat{\mu}^{(0,2)}$ differ by factors of $v$ as each subsequent moment removes an integration over space and introduces one over time.

*McGuire et al.* [2002] use the second-order spatial moments to define a characteristic rupture velocity, $v_c$, and take the ratio against the centroid velocity, $v_0$, to yield the directivity ratio, $D$,

$$D = \frac{v_0}{v_c} = \frac{\hat{\mu}^{(1,1)}}{\sqrt{\hat{\mu}^{(0,2)}\,\hat{\mu}^{(2,0)}}} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{L_0^2}}\frac{L_0^4 - 6x_h^2 L_0^2 + 4x_h^3 L_0}{\sqrt{L_0^4 - 12x_h^2 L_0^2 + 24x_h^3 L_0 - 12x_h^4}}. \tag{A9}$$

Considering the more general case in which only a portion of the fault ruptures (Figure 1), then in (A9), we (1) replace fault length, $L_0$, with rupture length, $L$; (2) replace hypocentral location on the fault, $x_h$, with the hypocentral location inside the rupture, $\alpha L$, yielding

$$D = \frac{1 - 6\alpha^2 + 4\alpha^3}{\sqrt{1 - 12\alpha^2 + 24\alpha^3 - 12\alpha^4}}. \tag{A10}$$

Directivity ratio is plotted as a function of $\alpha$ in Figure 9a. The adequacy of the approximation (A10) is discussed in Appendix C.

## Appendix B: Algorithm for Calculating Rupture Arrest

Figure B1 presents in greater detail the steps involved in calculating the arrest locations of the two rupture fronts of the earthquake simulated in Figure 6. In this particular example, pressure buildup and strength reduction result in an earthquake hypocenter at approximately $x^* = 0.51$. This location is calculated by iteration through fault pressure profiles output by the reservoir simulator at fixed times over a 50 year period. Linear interpolation is used to correct for overshoot of strength and also to discriminate between multiple potential hypocenters. For the parameters used here, the critical nucleation length is smaller than the fault discretization and it is therefore unnecessary to satisfy the Mohr-Coulomb criterion across multiple adjacent grid blocks.

Referring to equation (16), the locations where the two rupture fronts stop propagating are given by the crack tip positions $a^*_-$ and $a^*_+$ at the point where both $v^*_-$ and $v^*_+$ are zero. To illustrate, Figures B1b and B1c contour the velocity of, respectively, the negative and positive crack tips for all possible positions of the crack tips; this corresponds to a surface in $a^*_- - a^*_+ - v^*_\pm$ space. Each crack tip is restricted to propagate in the positive velocity region and must arrest somewhere on a contour of zero velocity.

In Figure B1d, positive and negative tip velocity regions from Figures B1b and B1c are superimposed. In this representation, rupture evolution corresponds to an unknown, monotonically increasing path in $a^*_- - a^*_+$ space, with the gradient of the path determined by the ratio of the two instantaneous tip velocities.

Our primary interest is in determining the final size of the rupture, indicated by the open square in Figure B1d; the path taken to reach this is not important for this study. An efficient algorithm for locating this end point is the crack tip "walk," which comprises a series of "strides" that alternate parallel to the $a^*_-$ and $a^*_+$ axes. Each stride holds the position of one crack tip constant and propagates the other along the fault until it arrests. The next stride then reverses roles: the tip that had previously advanced is now held fixed and the other tip is permitted to propagate and arrest. Thus, the rupture "walks" toward a configuration where both tips are arrested, the final rupture extent. In implementing this algorithm, we have found that to avoid the walk getting "stuck" on rough contours edges, it is useful to reduce actual stride lengths to 75% of the projected length.

Implementation of the crack tip walk algorithm represents considerable computational savings as compared to computing tip velocities in the full $a^*_- - a^*_+$ space (as is done in Figure B1). For a fault discretized into $N$ elements, each row or column of the 2-D matrix $v^*_\pm$ is computed by a single convolution (see equation (16)). For the crack tip walk, a single convolution is required for each stride; thus, operational savings over mapping out the full $a^*_- - a^*_+$ space are of order $N$.

## Appendix C: Comparison Against Dynamic Rupture Simulation

We compare the fracture mechanics approximation of rupture equation (16) to dynamic earthquake simulations in MDSBI (Multidimensional spectral boundary integral code [*Dunham*, 2005]), which models shear stress transfer and friction evolution on a 2-D planar fault. MDSBI implements a spectral boundary integral formulation [*Geubelle and Rice*, 1995] to calculate stress transfer due to fault slip. We use MDSBI in dynamic mode, which assumes a finite elastic wave speed. Friction evolves on the fault according to a rate-and-state model [*Dieterich and Kilgore*, 1996] with state evolution governed by a slip law. In dynamic mode, MDSBI has been verified against several problems of the Southern California Earthquake Center Dynamic Earthquake Rupture Code Verification Exercise.

We construct spatially correlated shear stress profiles, $\tau^*$, according to the description in section 2.3 with average stress high enough that, in the MDSBI simulation. Mode III rupture nucleates spontaneously before propagating and arresting at or before the end of the fault. The ends of the fault are padded with a region of velocity strengthening friction to enforce rupture arrest and isolate the simulation from boundary effects. The fault is sufficiently discretized to properly resolve the cohesive zone [*Day et al.*, 2005], the region at the propagating crack tip across which friction drops to its residual value.

Figure C1 compares the simulated rupture length, $L^*$, for 83 realizations of $\tau^*$. The relative error in simulated rupture length between MDSBI, $L^*_{\mathrm{MDSBI}}$, and the fracture mechanics approximation, $L^*_{\mathrm{FM}}$, is computed as $(L^*_{\mathrm{FM}} - L^*_{\mathrm{MDSBI}})/L^*_{\mathrm{MDSBI}}$, with agreement better than a factor of 2 in 73 cases. On average, the fracture mechanics approximation overestimates $L^*$ by 16% because tip interactions (which reduce the stress intensity factor) are

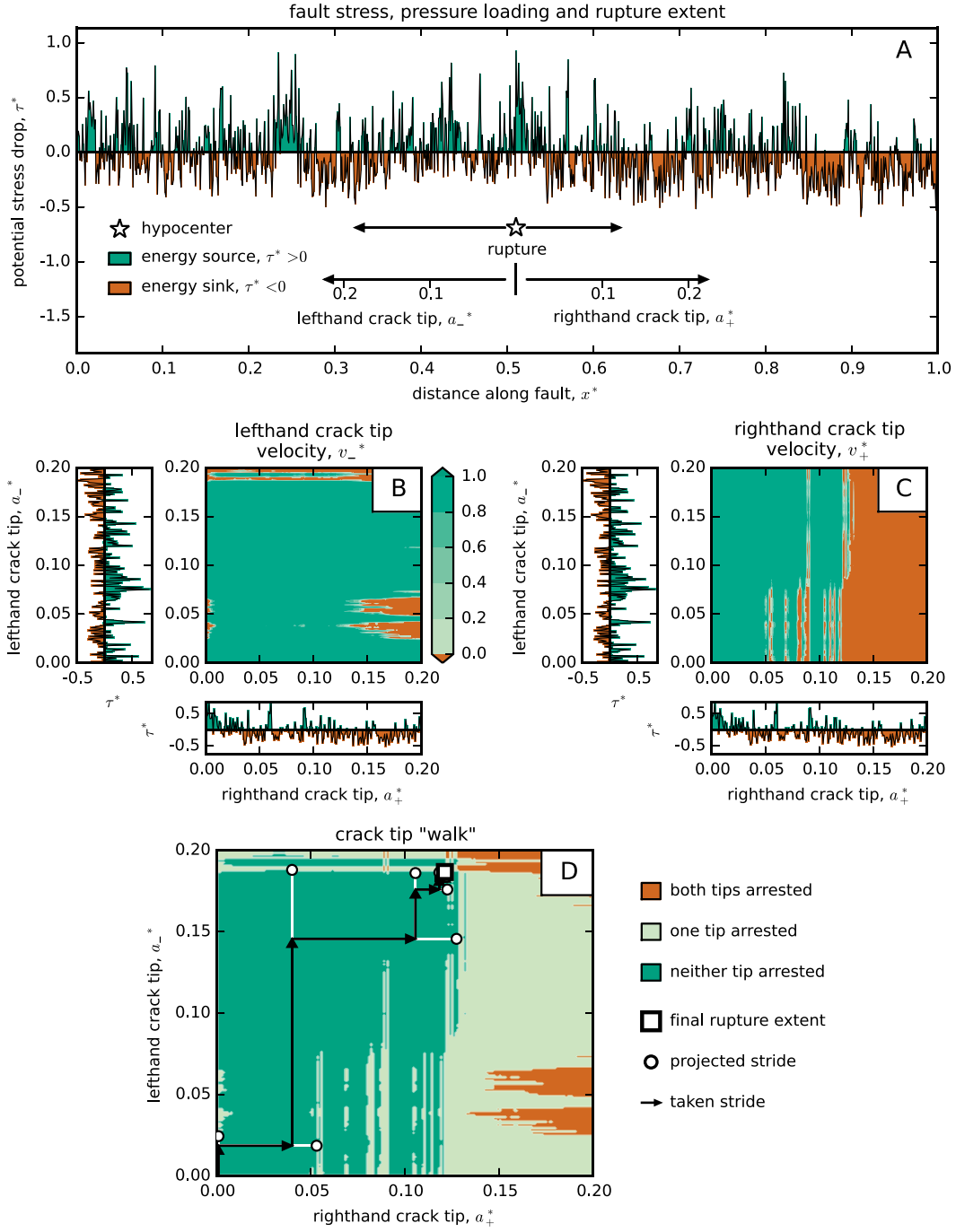



**Figure B1.** Illustration of the crack tip walk algorithm for calculating rupture extent, $L^*$, for the heterogeneous shear stress profile in Figure 6. (a) Once the hypocenter location, $x_h^*$ has been determined (Figure 6a); two axes are defined for the left-hand and right-hand crack tip positions, $a_-^*$ and $a_+^*$, with origins at $x_h^*$ and pointing in opposite directions along the fault. (b) Left-hand crack tip velocity, $v_-^*$ as a function of $a_-^*$ and $a_+^*$ (see equation (16)) with corresponding stress profiles from Figure B1a for reference. (c) As for Figure B1b but plotting the right-hand crack tip velocity, $v_+^*$. Note $v_\pm^*$ begins to decrease when it enters an orange area, which for the right-hand crack tip corresponds to the sustained area of $\tau^* < 0$ at $a_+^* > 0.12$. (d) Crack tip velocity maps from Figures B1b and B1 are superimposed to illustrate areas of crack tip growth (dark green), partial arrest (light green), and full arrest (orange). The crack can only grow within contiguous dark green regions, and the final rupture extent is given by the white square. Calculation of rupture extent by a series of projected (white circles) and taken crack tip "strides" (black solid arrow) is shown.

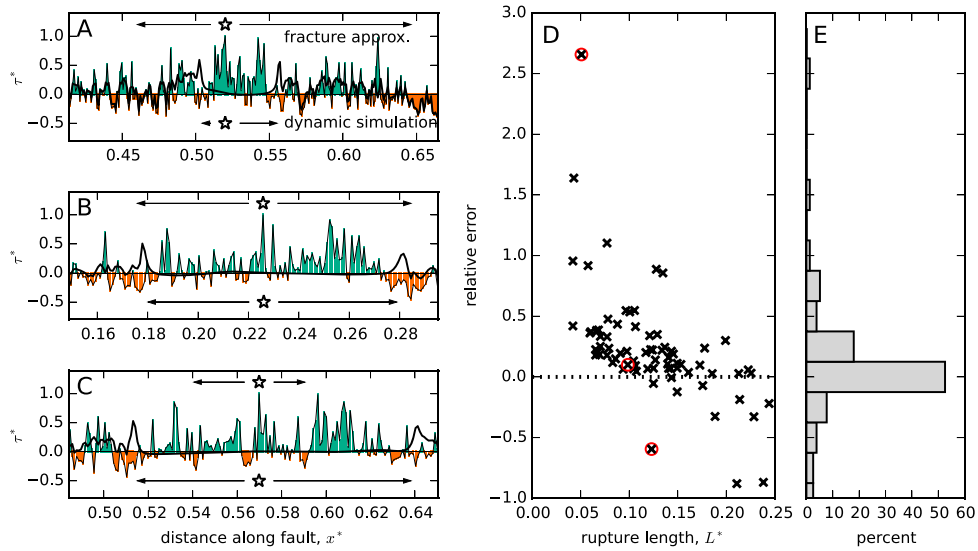



**Figure C1.** Comparison of rupture extent, $L^*$, predicted by the fracture mechanics method and dynamic rupture simulator, MDSBI. (a–c) Realizations of heterogeneous stress, $\tau^*$, and extent of rupture as predicted by fracture mechanics (over arrow) and as simulated by MDSBI (under arrow). Green and orange regions correspond to positive and negative stress drop. The postrupture stress state from MDSBI is overlaid on $\tau^*$ as a thick black line. Stress concentrations at the location of rupture arrest are evident. (d) Relative error in estimating $L^*$ between our model and MDSBI for 83 different stress realizations. (e) Histogram of the errors.

not included. Occasionally, this results in a large overestimate of $L^*$ (e.g., Figure C1a) when a low stress zone that arrests a dynamic rupture allows the fracture mechanics rupture to propagate across into another high stress region. Sometimes also, the fracture mechanics method underestimates $L^*$. This occurs for stress states defined such that multiple sections of the fault nucleate and slip concurrently in the dynamic simulation (e.g., Figure C1c).

### C1. Moment and Directivity Approximations

The seismic moment for a 1-D rupture is defined

$$M_0 = \mu \int_{a_-}^{a_+} u(x)\mathrm{d}x, \tag{C1}$$

where $\mu$ is the shear modulus, $a_-$ and $a_+$ are the left-hand and right-hand limits of rupture, and $u$ is the slip on the fault. On faults with heterogeneous stress, $M_0$ is given [*Madariaga*, 1979; *Ampuero et al.*, 2006]

$$M_0 = L^2 \int_{-1}^{1} \Delta\tau(z)\sqrt{1-z^2}\mathrm{d}z, \tag{C2}$$

where $\Delta\tau$ is the distribution of stress drop and $L$ is the rupture length. For our fracture mechanics analysis, we do not simulate slip, $u$, and therefore must use (C2). The adequacy of this approach is verified by direct comparison with the dynamic rupture simulations, which are in quite good agreement (Figure C2a).

In developing an approximation of the directivity ratio, $D$, equation (A10), we assumed a model in which moment release occurs instantaneously at the rupture front and that is constant across the rupture. Dynamic rupture simulations provide a more realistic evolution of slip and slip velocity and allow us to compute exactly the moment equations (A7) and (A8) that define $D$. For the 83 simulations in Figure C2b, plots $D$ computed by the approximate expression (A10) versus exact value given by (A9) with (A7) and (A8). The moments are calculated from records of slip and slip velocity following the method developed in Appendix F of [*Ampuero and Ben-Zion*, 2008]. The exact and approximate expressions agree qualitatively in terms of the direction of rupture travel. However, the exact computation results in set of values for $D$ that are much weaker than observations of real earthquakes [*McGuire et al.*, 2002]. *Ampuero and Ben-Zion* [2008] considered $D$ for rupture pulses on bimaterial faults with heterogeneous stress and saw that the shape of the distribution depends on $\sigma_\tau^*$ and closely

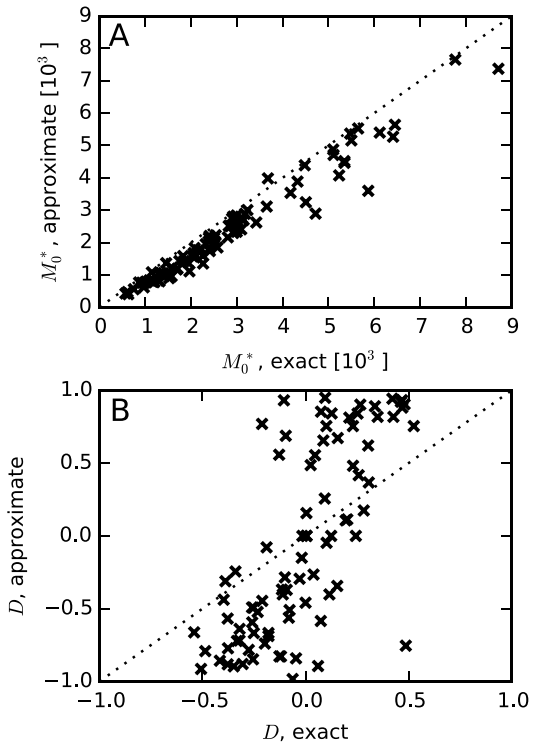



**Figure C2.** Comparison of exact and approximate values of (a) seismic moment, $M_0$, and (b) directivity ratio, $D$, for 83 dynamic rupture simulations. Perfect agreement is indicated by a dotted line. We suggest that the lack of agreement is due to simulation of crack-like ruptures versus the pulse-like nature of the approximation (A10).

resembled observations when $\sigma_\tau^* = 0.25$. One possible reason for the disagreement between our results and those in *Ampuero and Ben-Zion* [2008] is that our ruptures are crack like, and thus, slip in the central regions occurs over a longer time period. In contrast, the pulses in *Ampuero and Ben-Zion* [2008] concentrate moment release to the front of the rupture, which is more consistent with the simple model (A2) used to develop the approximate expression for $D$. In spite of this, equation (A10) appears to be a reasonable first-order approximation in that, when combined with several possible distributions of $\alpha$, it yields a good match to observed distributions of directivity ratio (section 3.3).

The question then naturally arises, how would conclusions drawn using the fracture mechanics model be different were a pulse-like model employed? We offer the following insights, although a rigorous analysis requires a deeper study of pulse models beyond the scope of this work.

1. Hypocenter locations and times are not modified, as earthquake triggering precedes the calculation of rupture.
2. *Nielsen and Madariaga* [2003] develop analytical solutions for an expanding 1-D self-healing slip pulse and compare this to the equivalent crack. They show that the stress intensity factor of the pulse could be smaller than that for the crack by up to a factor of 2. Furthermore, rupture arrest may occur more rapidly for the pulse because, below a critical rupture velocity, $v_r$, energy release rate decreases with decreasing $v_r$. Thus, $L^*$ is potentially smaller for pulses than cracks.
3. The slip distribution inside a pulse-like rupture increases linearly with distance from the hypocenter [*Nielsen and Madariaga*, 2003]. Thus, when computing mean stress drop for a moment calculation, greater weight is placed on the low stress drop regions that occur preferentially near the edge of the rupture pulse. Using this modified weighting scheme for the simulated ruptures in Figure C2a, the average stress drop of the pulse is ~30% smaller than for the crack.
4. Both the smaller rupture length and smaller stress drop for pulses equate to smaller event magnitudes. This ultimately modifies the shape of the magnitude-frequency distribution. However, our study specifically focuses on earthquake ensembles whose magnitude-frequency distribution conforms to a Gutenberg-Richter (GR) model. Using a modified stress intensity factor (assuming the maximum reduction of a factor of 2) and average stress drop computed for a pulse, GR scaling of the magnitude-frequency distribution with $b \sim 1$ is obtained for a fractal exponent of 0.4 (rather than 0.25 for the crack model).

The immediate suggestion then is that a model assuming pulse-like rupture would require a different parameterization of the heterogeneous stress model. However, the core features of the fracture mechanics model upon which the primary conclusions are justified—ruptures triggered by Mohr-Coulomb failure, rupture arrest in regions of negative stress drop, and conditions for continued rupture promoted in regions of elevated fluid pressure—are largely independent of the particulars of the stress model parameterization. Thus, we suggest that the collective properties of induced earthquake sequences discussed in this and the accompanying paper will, at least qualitatively, exhibit similar behavior for cracks and pulses.

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